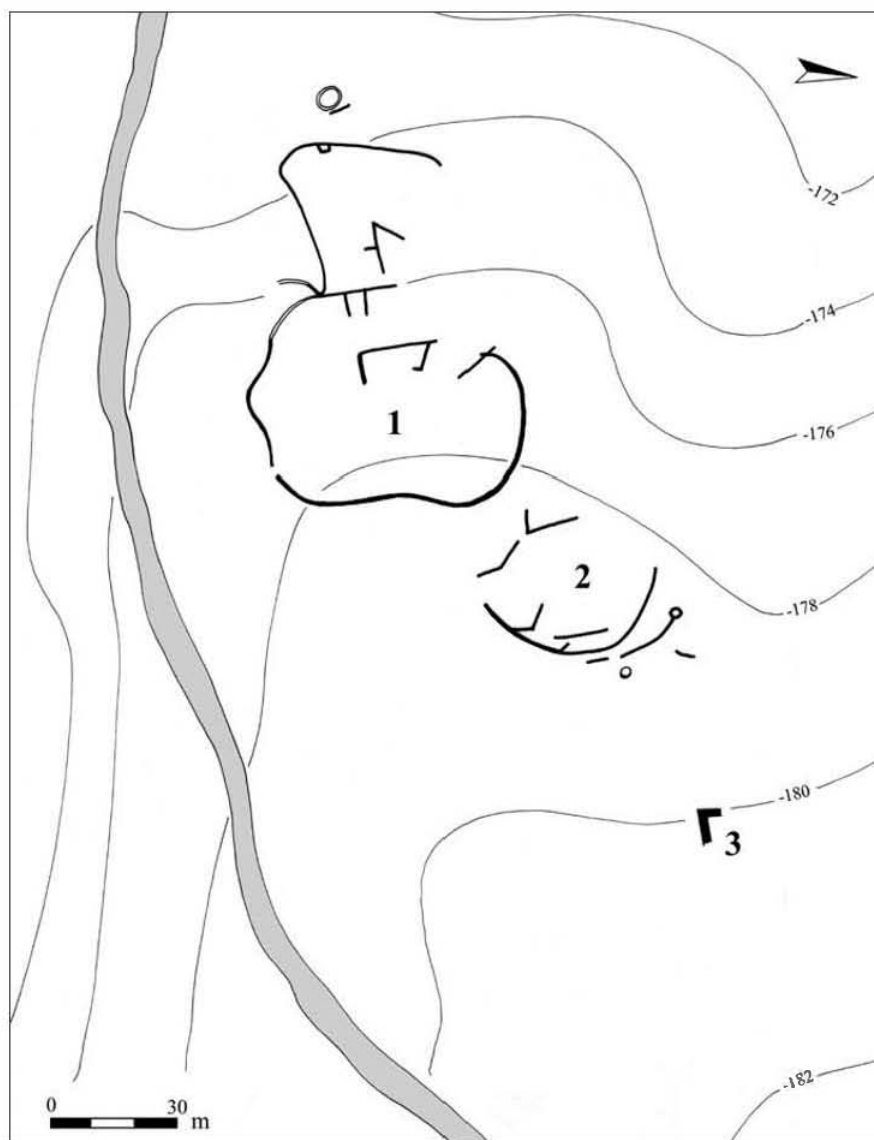


Pottery: Chalcolithic/Early Bronze I – 35%; Iron I – 10%; Iron II – 5%; Byzantine – 50%.

Flint: 19 items, including a Canaanite blade, see Appendix A and Bar 2014a: site 72.

Additional surveys: none.

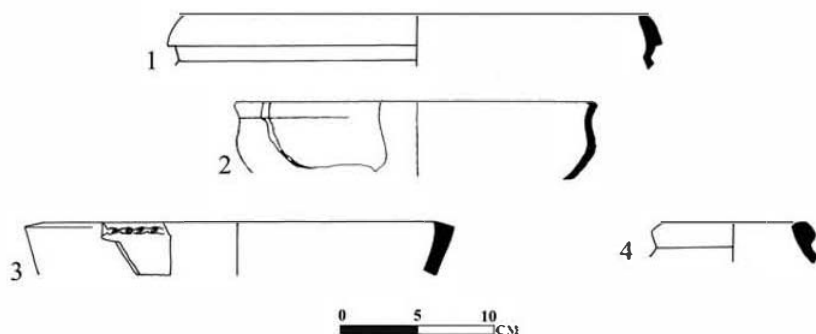
Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 72.



193. Plan of Masu'a (9), 1993.



194. Masu'a (9), the large enclosure, 1998.



195. Pottery from Masu'a (9): 1. CP or krater, dk brn, Ir I; 2. Bowl, brn, Ir I; 3. Bowl, cream, rope-dec, Chal; 4. Jar, Ir II.

Site 97: 19-16/66/5

MASU'A (3)

Israel grid: 1961/1668	Soil quality: 3
UTM grid: 7347/5538	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 189 m b.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
Site type: enclosures	3.2 km distant
Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
Topography: valley margins	1 km distant
Rock type: Avdat Group	Visits: April 1996, March 2001; 43
Soil type: stony-desert	sherds

A site in a valley in the eastern fringes of the Sartaba range, midway between Masu'a and Yafit. There is a good view to the Jordan Valley: it is connected to the north-west to E.P. -189 (Site 93).

The site location is in a depression, enclosed by hills to the north and south, between the channel of Wadi Habeij and the high spur descending from the Sartaba range. There are three parts to the site:

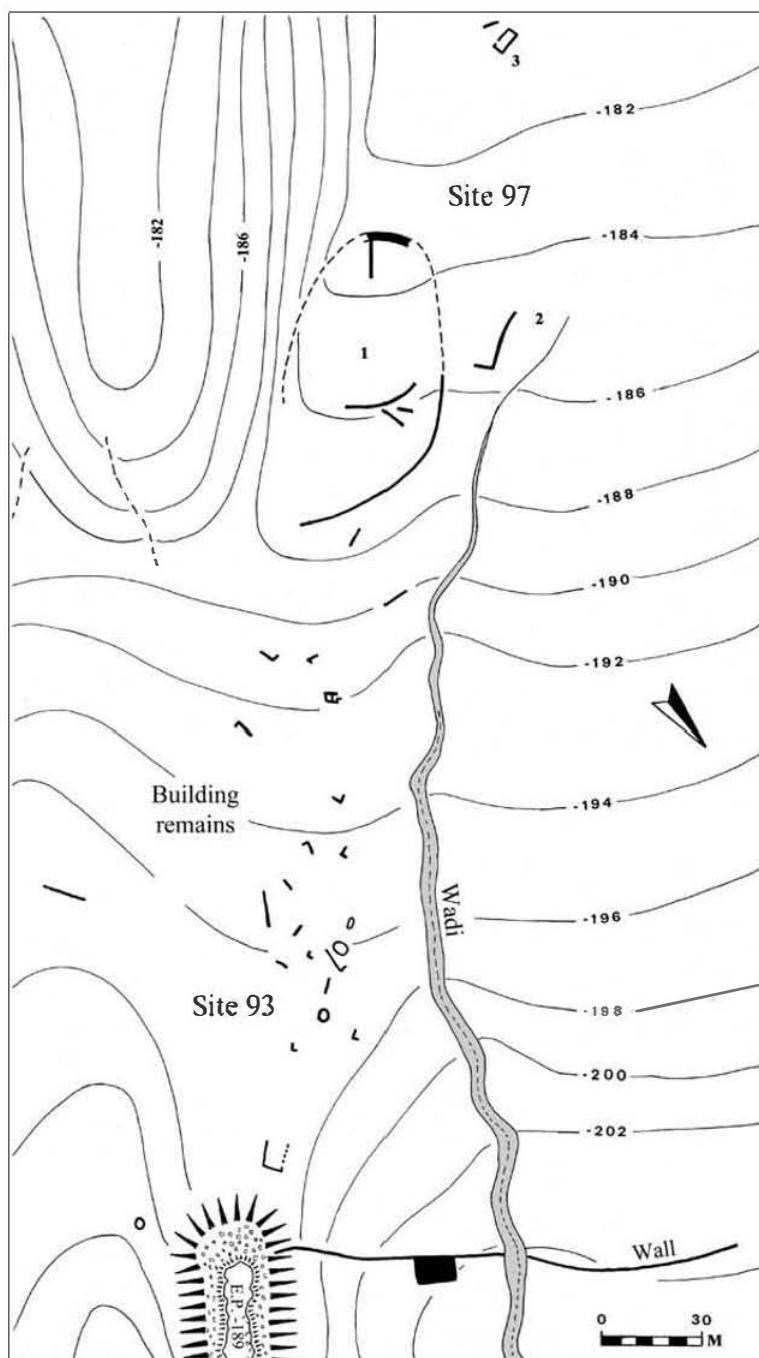
1. Remains of a large oval enclosure, with its axis aligned NE-SW, about 90×50 m in size; and its outer wall about 1.2 m wide built of two rows of medium-sized stones. The completing wall section in the west is built in a different style: it is about 4 m wide and built of two walls with filling between them. It is not certain whether this section belongs to the rest of enclosure parts.
- In the centre of the eastern third is a section of curved wall, built in similar style to that of the outer enclosure wall, and parallel to it: it is about 24 m long and perhaps served as inner partition. Inside the enclosure are various walls and structures. It can be assumed that this enclosure is the most ancient in the site.
2. About 20 m north west of the enclosure was another wall section built in the same style; perhaps originally linked to the oval enclosure.
3. About 70 m south west of the enclosure are several structures built of large stones. The relation between them and the enclosure is not clear.

It may be that Masu'a (3) and E.P. -189 were one site, consisting of a settlement and enclosures.

Pottery: Iron I – 7%; Iron II – 42%; Late Roman – 51%.

Flint: 4 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



196. Plan of Masu'a (3) and E.P. -189, 2001. Masu'a (3) enclosures are in the south (marked 1-3), E.P. -189 is along Wadi Habeij in the north-east. Notice the wall crossing the valley.



197. The inner part of Masu'a Valley, view to the south-west. The Masu'a (3) enclosures have been preserved in this area, 1995.



Site 98: 19-16/66/6

TELL 'ABEID (1)

Israel grid: 1968/1662

UTM grid: 7354/5531

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name: as in the British Survey map

Site type: fortress

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: shoulder over a slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

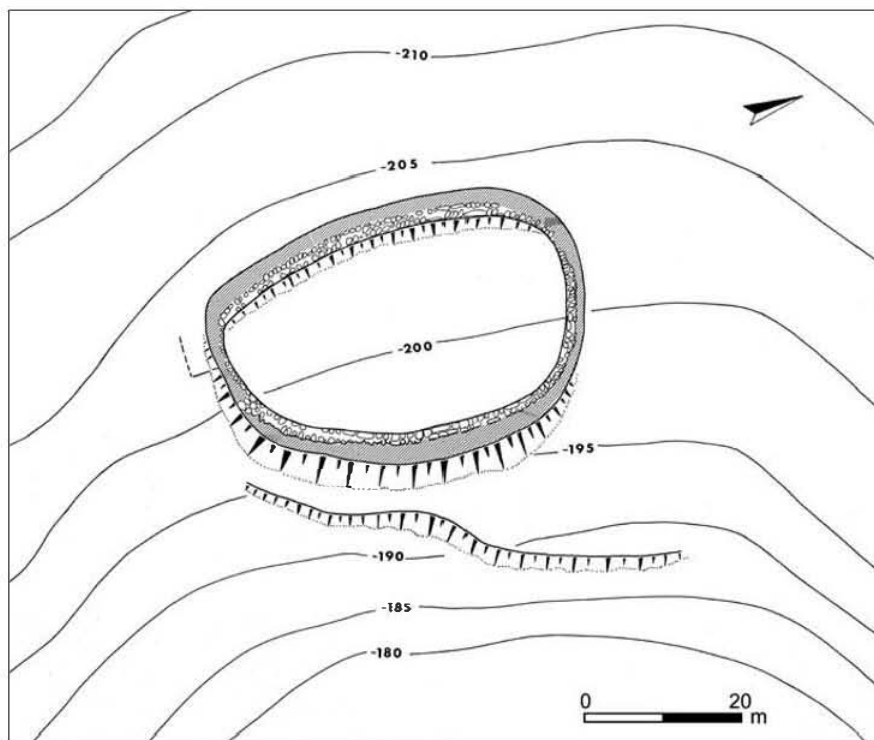
Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2.4 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
300 m distant

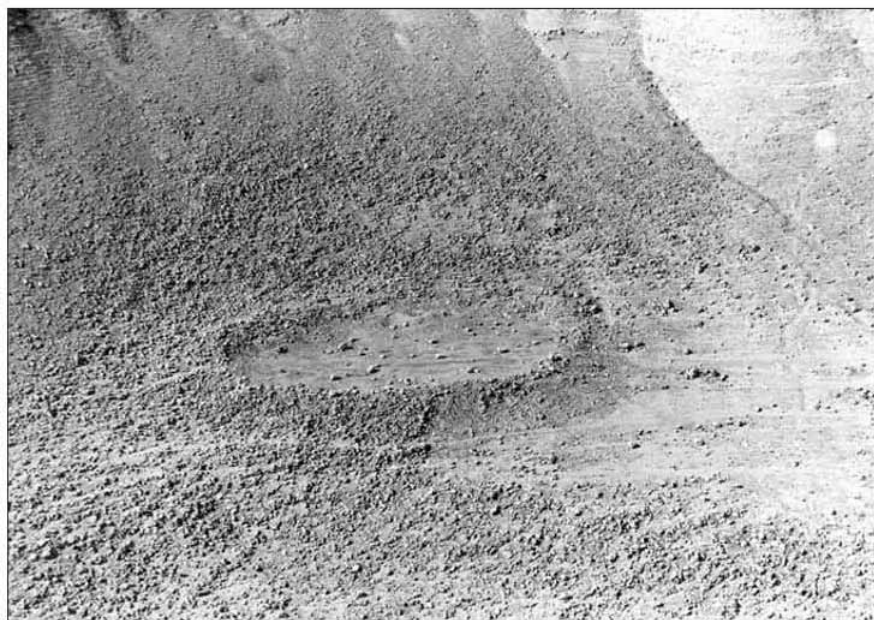
Visit: March 1999; 55 sherds

A fort on a shoulder, west and above the Beit She'an–Jericho road, about 3 km east-south-east of the Sartaba, and 3 km north-east of Yaffit. Above the shoulder upon which the fort is positioned rises a line of cliffs.

An oval fort was erected in the narrow valley, measuring about 40 m long by 28 m maximum width. Its southern end is slightly narrower than the northern one. The fort walls are built of medium and large stones, laid in rows. The



198. Plan of Tell 'Abeid (1), 1999.



199. Aerial view of Tell 'Abeid (1), 1999 (M. Weinberg).

width of the eastern and western walls, which are perpendicular to the slope, is about 3 m, and the width of the northern and southern connecting walls is about 1.2 m.

Below the eastern wall on the steep slope is another wall supporting the building. The inside of the site is full of silt, which covered the inner walls, and the entrance was not found. Sherds are scattered throughout.

About 50 m north of the fort are small stone structures, their purpose unknown.

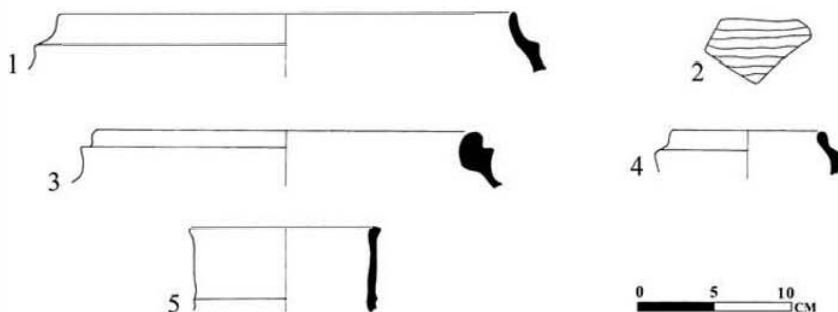
About 200 m to the south is another fort ('Abeid [2]).

The site was probably an IA fort, established to guard the road. Roman forts have a different plan (square with casements). Both forts in Tell 'Abeid were evidently established to guard the roads during the period of the Israelite Kingdom, possibly in the 11th century BCE, and kept in service for a long time.

Pottery: Iron Ic – 6%; Iron II – 54%; Late Roman-Byzantine – 40%.

Flint: 35 items, IA, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



200. Pottery from Tell 'Abeid (1): 1. CP, dk brn, Ir I; 2. Body fragment, brn, Byz; 3. CP, dk brn, Ir II; 4. Jar, brn, Ir I-II; 5. Jar, lt brn, Rom.

Site 99: 19-16/66/7

TELL 'ABEID (2)

Israel grid: 1967/1660	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7353/5529	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: ancient and on map	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), 2.4 km distant
Site type: fortress	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), 400 m distant
Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha)	Visits: March 1999, plan - Nov. 2001;
Topography: shoulder over a slope	85 sherds
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

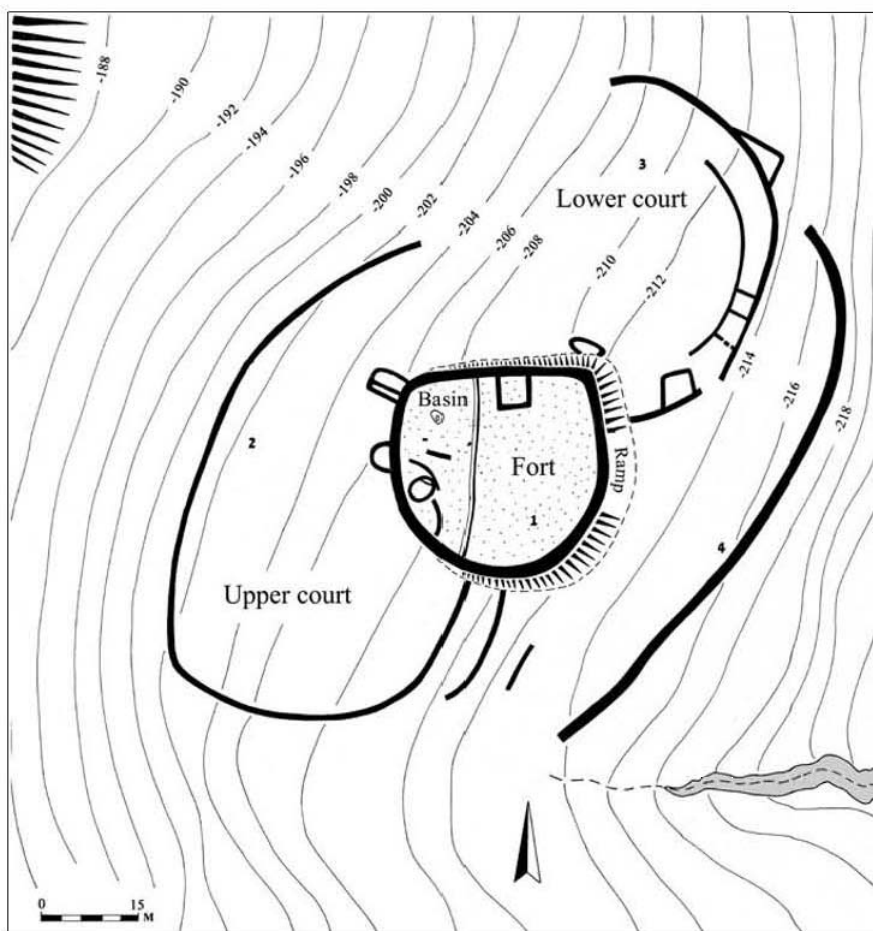
An apsidal fortress over a shoulder and above the line of cliffs, about 3 km east-south-east of the Sartaba summit and 2.5 km south of Masu'a. The fortress is close to and commands the Jordan Valley road.

The fortress, measuring about 30×30 m, is situated on a large ramp, formed by an array of support-walls. It consists of four parts – the fortress itself and three courtyards:

1. The fortress is an apsidal structure: its north wall is straight, and the other walls meet it in a semicircle. The walls are 1.5-2 m wide, built of large fieldstones. Each wall is built of two rows of stones, and some of them are built in a rampart-like manner (the bottom course projects). Part of the walls still stand to three to five courses, about 1.5 m, high. The opening was possibly in the north, but it has not been positively located. The inside of the fortress is full of silt, covering the internal walls. The fortress is supported by a large masonry rampart, 5-6 m wide, elevating the wall bases by approximately 3 m. The western high part of the fortress is detached from the eastern part by a wall, only partially preserved. This wall is a continuation of the upper courtyard (No. 2), perhaps connecting walls to it from the west – from the fortress wall. In this area was found a stone with a basin cut into it. A room measuring 6×6 m is attached to the inside of the straight northern wall. In the upper part of the fortress are small new structures built (by shepherds?) from the fortress collapse stones. Various structures are attached to the fortress wall on the outside, both west and north.
2. The upper courtyard, which is attached to the fortress on the south-west, enveloping it from above, is built in a large arc, and is about 66 m long by 36 m wide. The total length of the upper courtyard wall is about 140

m, and it is built of two rows of medium-sized fieldstones. The courtyard wall extends southwards from the fortress wall, climbing up and along the slope contour, maintaining a distance of 25–30 m from the fort wall. From here the wall turns north, passes above the fort, and terminates in front of the fort's north-western corner. The northern wall of the courtyard was not preserved. Possibly it was built, like the rest of the walls, in order to secure the fort from floods and to create a podium for it.

3. The lower north-western courtyard forms a podium in the north-eastern side of the fort. Together with the upper courtyard an artificial shoulder was formed, while the fort bridges the two courtyards. The upper courtyard is also incomplete, and has a bow-like shape open to the west, with a diameter of 36 m. The western edge of courtyard wall connects to the fort. It seems that it was a double wall, and short connecting walls



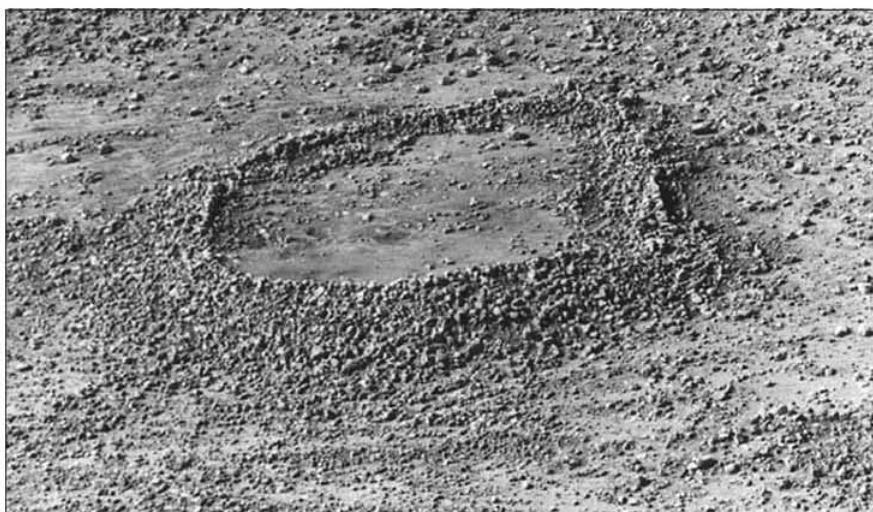
201. Plan of Tell 'Abeid (2), 2001.

produced casements possibly built to strengthen the wall. Close to the fort was found a room attached to the courtyard wall.

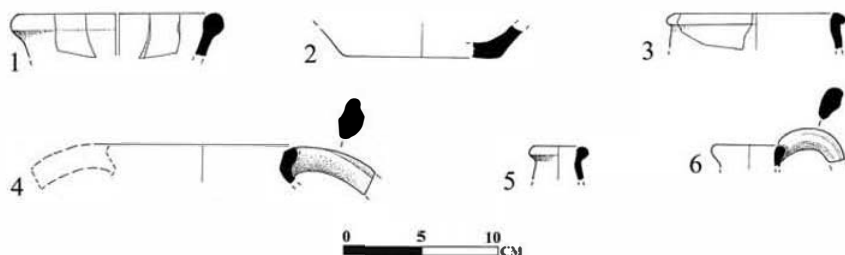
4. The bottom support wall, east and below the two courtyards on the edge of the slope, is 90 m long and curved, supporting most of the length of the fort and both courtyards. It is about 2 m wide, built of medium-sized fieldstones.

In the fort and the courtyards is a moderate scatter of sherds.

This is the principal and more important of the two Tell 'Abeid forts. Great effort was invested in its construction and stabilization, and a complex of courtyards was added. Its shape, which is similar to Tell 'Abeid (1), and the almost identical pottery find, suggest that this was a pair of forts, functioning together, perhaps similarly to the IA fortresses in the Negev. It is also likely that one of the forts replaced the other one.



202. Aerial view of the fort at Tell 'Abeid (2), 1999 (M. Weinberg).



203. Pottery from Tell 'Abeid (2): 1. Jar-jug, lt brn, Ir I-II; 2. Base, brn, Ir I; 3. Jar, buff, LR; 4. Jug/flask, buff, Ir I; 5. Juglet, cream, LR; 6. Juglet, buff, Ir I-II.

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 6%; Iron Ic – 10%; Iron II – 50%; Hellenistic – 2%; Late Roman – 31%; Middle Ages – 1%.

Flint: 14 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 100: 19-16/65/1

YAFIT (8)

Israel grid: 1961/1650

UTM grid: 7347/5520

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: silt cover

Soil type: marl

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
3 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
500 m distant

Visit: March 1996, 2015; 36 sherds

A farm built at the western edge of the Yafit Valley, about 1.5 km north-east of Yafit.

In the site are two courtyards and dwelling structures. The larger courtyard is oval, about 18 m across. It is built of large stones laid in a single row. To the south-east, adjacent to it, is a smaller courtyard, about 13 m in diameter. Where the two courtyards meet is a small round structure 4 m in diameter, built to the same pattern.

North of the larger courtyard is another oval structure, about 7 m across, built of larger stones. It is feasible that it served as family dwelling.

The site is a farm or seasonal dwelling place, built and used during IA II. It is likely that there is linkage between it and a group of cairns (tombs) found over the ridge to the north-west.

In a return visit in 2015 we noticed that the western part of the upper courtyard had been destroyed during the construction of a new unpaved road.

Pottery: Iron II – 80%; Early Roman – 20%.

Flint: 75 items, possibly IA II, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



204. Plan of Yafit (8), 1996.



Site 101:19-16/75/1

ABU NUGEILAT

Israel grid: 197●/1653

UTM grid: 7356/5522

Elevation: 27● m b.s.l., 2● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: courtyard

Area: 5 dunams (5●●● sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

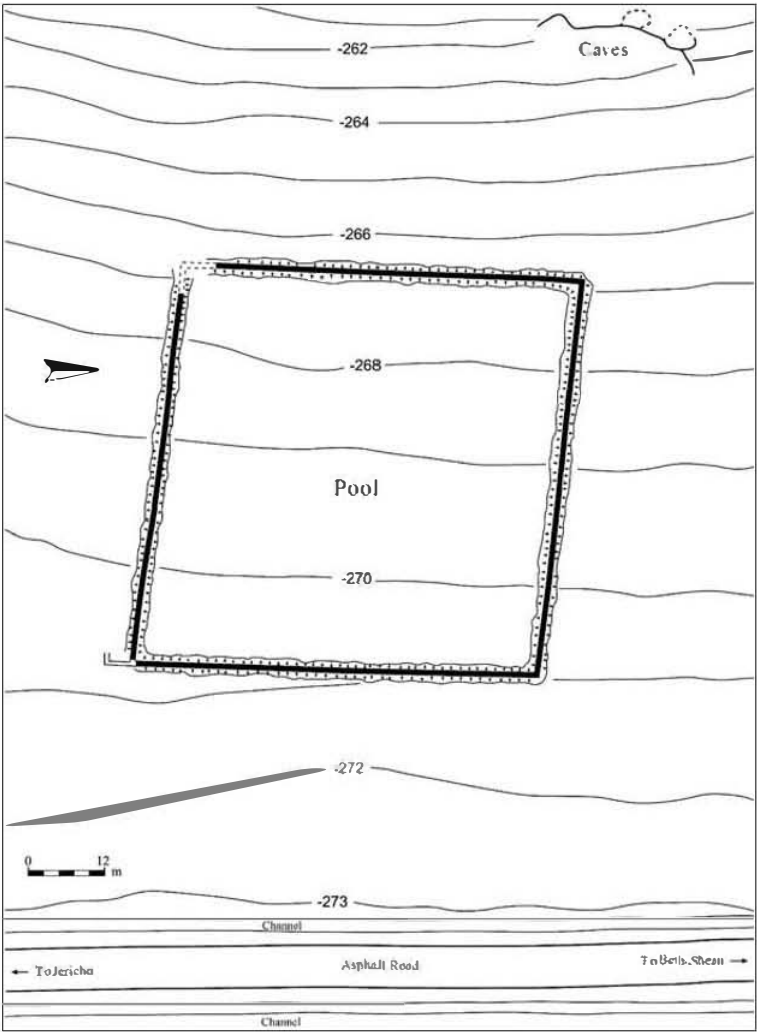
Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2.5 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
next to the site

Visit: March 2002; 3● sherds

A large courtyard at the edge of the Jordan Valley, 5● m west of the Beit She'an–Jericho road, and about 2 km north-west of Yafit.

The site is placed between the low cliffs east of the el-Mastara ridge and the road. It consists of a square pool-like courtyard measuring 63×63 m. The walls are well preserved in several places, built of small cut stones, and about 7● cm



205. Plan of AbuNugeilat, 2003.



206. Pottery from Abu Nugeilat: 1. 'Frying pan', lt brn, Byz; 2. Jar, lt brn, Byz.

wide. Nowadays they project 1 m above the surface and are noticeable as low ridges containing small stones which fell out of the ruined walls. In the south-eastern corner are the remains of a small square cell, perhaps belonging to the original structure. Around the place are moderate scatters of homogeneous sherds.

The site was discovered by the Emergency Survey, and its description is: "A pool by the Jiftlik road, plastered, of dimensions 100×50 m. The walls are 80-100 cm thick. Pottery: from the Roman, Byzantine and 'Arabic periods." (Bar-Adon 1972: site 7).

The measurable dimensions and pottery find in the description above do not fit our data and we only collected Byz sherds. Also, despite a thorough scrutiny, we failed to find plaster remains.

The function of the courtyard is not certain. Without plaster, it is difficult to establish whether it was a pool or water reservoir. The location is also unsuitable for such facilities, because there is no river channel here to serve as water source, and the structure is not built in a hollow.

Pottery (in our survey): Byzantine – 100%.

Additional surveys: Bar-Adon 1972: site 7.



Site 102: 19-16/54/1

YAFIT (7)

Israel grid: 1950/1640

UTM grid: 7337/5509

Elevation: 210 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil types: stony-desert and marl

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
4.5 km distant

Road: Wadi Qurein–Sartaba (C45),
next to the site

Visit: March 1996; 30 sherds

An enclosure in the margins of the Yafit Valley, about 800 m north of the centre of Yafit. The paved road ascending to Sartaba passes nearby.

The site is east and below the Yafit water reservoir. The remains found are a curved stone wall, about 5 m wide, 30 m in diameter. The enclosure is open to the north and west.

The site could be related to the Jericho–Beit She'an road. Sherds are scattered around in moderate numbers.

Pottery: Iron II – 20%; Late Roman – 80%.

Flint: 1 item, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 102 (1): 19-16/44/1

YAFIT TUMULI

Israel grid: 1949/1642

UTM grid: 7336/5508

Elevation: 165 m b.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: burial

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil types: stony-desert and marl

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
4 km distant

Road: Wadi Qurein–Sartaba (C45),
300 m distant

Two tumuli excavated by Y. Magen (2004) during the construction of a water reservoir 500 m north of Yafit. The tumuli are situated on a very steep sloping ridge with fine views of the Jordan Valley.

The first tumulus is 9 m in diameter and contains a circular inner cell 3 m in diameter. Its walls were built of large uncut stones. The construction had two phases: first the inner cell, and then the outer circle. After both circles had been completed the space between them was filled with small stones and a truncated cone shape was created. In the inner circle large flat stones were found – apparently the covering of the inner cell. There were no finds in this tumulus.

The second tumulus is 7 m in diameter, and the inner cell is 3.5 m in diameter. It was built of very large stones that appear to have been smoothed. The construction phasing was similar to the first tumulus. This tumulus had many finds, found outside the inner cell. Amongst the finds are jewellery (a silver earring, a silver ring, a fibula, beads, and a seashell bracelet), a coin dated to the mid-4th century BCE, an LBA scarab and cylinder seal, a bronze mirror, iron arrowheads and a knife. The pottery was dated to the end of the IA and the

Persian period. Six burial remains were found, amongst them two female and one male, their ages ranging from 12 to 50 years.

As the excavator suggests, the tumulus reflects a family burial tradition lasting 150–200 years. It is important to note that this is the first example of a tumulus burial in the Persian period in the region.

Pottery: Iron II; Persian.

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Brandl 2004.



Site 103: 19-16/63/1

EL-MARMALEH

Israel grid: 1969/1638

UTM grid: 7356/5508

Elevation: 258 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: on map

Site type: pools

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: Lisan marl

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), 500
m distant

Visit: March 2002; 10 sherds

A ruined site of pools in the Jordan Valley, 500 m east of the Beit She'an–Jericho road.

In the past, an unpaved road, nowadays planted with date-palms, led in the direction of the site. The area has been almost totally devastated due to infrastructure works and local agricultural activities. In the vicinity of E.P. -258 is a new earth dike, the builders of which destroyed the ancient pools. Only an oval enclosure, about 35 m across, survived with a hollow in it, perhaps a remnant of one of the pools.

The Emergency Survey noted: "Structural remains and two pools, one round, 25 m in diameter, and the second one elliptical, measuring 28×13 m. Pottery is from the Roman-Byzantine period." (Bar-Adon 1972: site 9).

Pottery (Summary of the different surveys): Roman; Byzantine.

Additional surveys: Bar-Adon 1972: site 9.

Site 104: 19-16/43/1

YAFIT (4)

Israel grid: 1941/1631	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7327/3550	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 220 m b.s.l., 60 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: Wadi Rashash (181), 2.5 km distant
Site type: village and enclosures	Road: Wadi 'Amraḥ–Sartaba (C46), 500 m distant
Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha)	Visits: March 1996, March 2002; 74 sherds
Topography: valley margins	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

A large site on a silt baulk in the Jordan Valley margins, below and east of the 'Iraq el-Mastara cliffs, and about 1 km south-west of the centre of Moshav Yafit.

The site is composed of a central enclosure and structures close by. The construction is of large and medium-sized stones in one or two rows. The site has three main parts:

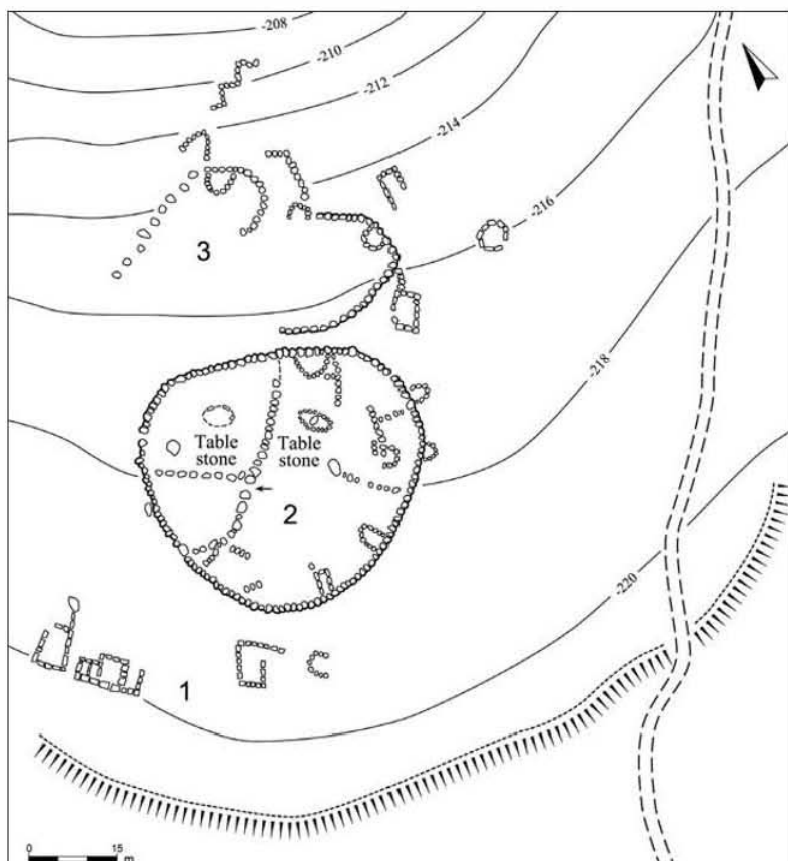
1. Four square and rounded structures, built of large stones on silt steps west of the central enclosure. The structures are about 5 m in diameter; one of them is divided into two rooms, and in another the entrance jambs and a large stone basin nearby are visible. The walls are built of a single row of large stones.
2. A large oval enclosure, whose maximum axis is about 40 m. Its perimeter wall is 1–1.5 m thick, built of two rows of large stones. The north-western part of the enclosure is divided by a wall, one stone thick, with another partition wall meeting it perpendicularly. Apparently, this enclosure was the site's principal component.
3. In the northern part of the site, close to the central enclosure, but not physically attached to it, were found the remains of two smaller enclosures. Their average diameter is about 15 m, and to them are connected structures, east and north, most of which are small rooms. It is likely that more structures, part of the walls of which became obscured by silt, once stood in the area.

Pottery: Middle Bronze II (?) – 2%; Iron I – 15%; Iron II – 60%; Late Roman – 23%.

Flint: 84 items, Upper Palaeolithic, see Appendix A.

Stone: A grinding stone, Iron Age (see Eitam 2005: 695).

Additional surveys: none.



207. Plan of Yafit (4), 2005.



208. Aerial view of the oval enclosure at Yafit (4), 2013 (A. Solomon).



209. A large stone structure at Yafit (4), no. 1 in the plan, 2003 (M. Einav).



Site 105: 19-16/32/3

YAFIT (3)

Israel grid: 1939/1628
 UTM grid: 7326/5497
 Elevation: 230 m b.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.
 Name: nearest place
 Site type: enclosure
 Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)
 Topography: valley margins
 Rock type: silt cover
 Soil types: stony-desert and marl

Soil quality: 2
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Water source: Wadi Rashash (181),
 2 km distant
 Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
 500 m distant
 Visits: March 1996, April 2002, and
 many more; 150 sherds

A 'sandal'-shape enclosure, with inner divisions and structures, located in the south-eastern margins of the Sartaba range. It is about 1 km south-west of Yafit, in a wide valley meeting the ridges descending from 'Urqan el-Mastara in the east.

The enclosure was built between several ravines and close to the road ascending from the Jordan Valley Monument to Tal'at 'Amreh. Above and to the west is a fairly steep rocky slope, enabling settling and a view into the

site that probably also served as the source of the building stones. To the site complex should be added an outer structure, a stone circle south of it, and a large enclosure 100 m to north-east.

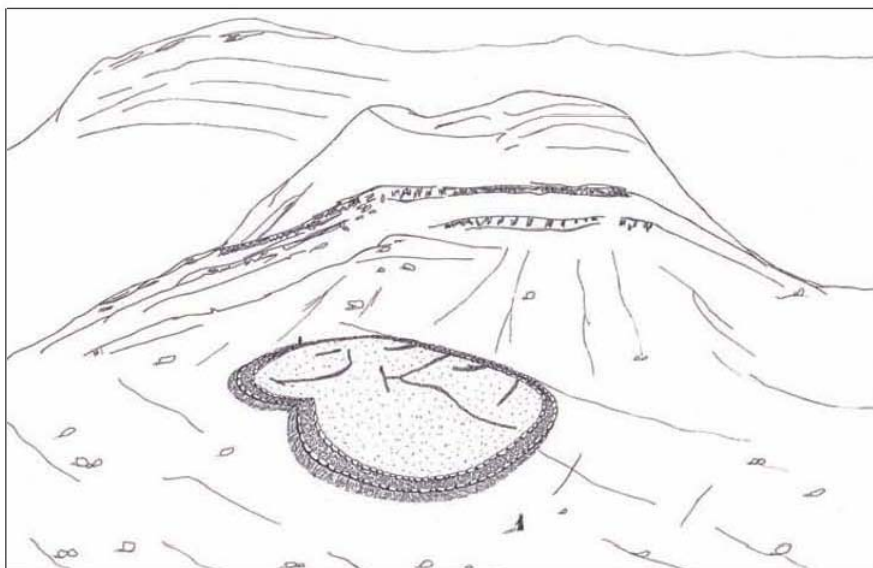
The enclosure is about 80 m long and about 45 m wide. It was built along a fairly deep ravine, descending from the ridge at the west to the plain, and parallel to it. The typical 'sandal' shape was formed in the north-eastern side, facing the deep ravine; where the narrow waist of the enclosure is.

The enclosure wall is built of two parallel walls with a 2.5–3 m gap between them. The inner of the two walls is built of one or two rows of medium-sized stones, strengthened occasionally by large standing stones. The width of this wall is 1 m on average, and the outer wall is built mostly of one row of medium-sized stones. The inner wall has been well preserved almost everywhere, and the outer one, less so. Between the two walls is a gap with no construction within. The appearance of both walls together indicates a pathway or 'processional way' (see Appendix C).

The interior of the enclosure is divided into 'quarters' by curved partition walls of single rows of medium-sized stones. These perhaps served as support walls, because one of the walls crosses the enclosure almost along its entire length. Around the inner walls and close by them are structures whose plans difficult to decipher. Some are square rooms and others rounded.

Over the whole area is a moderate sherd scatter and flint items.

This interesting site resembles a 'sandal', or *Gilgal*, similar to the enclosures at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Site 65, and Masu'a (4) – Site 92. The resemblance is



210. Reconstruction of Yafit (3), drawn by A. Gadir.

in the shape, inner layout, position in relation to the terrain (in the plain and generally beneath a cliff slope) and foundation and utilization in the IA 1. The site suggests a possible role as a place of assembly (see discussion in Chapter 1, Section D: 6).

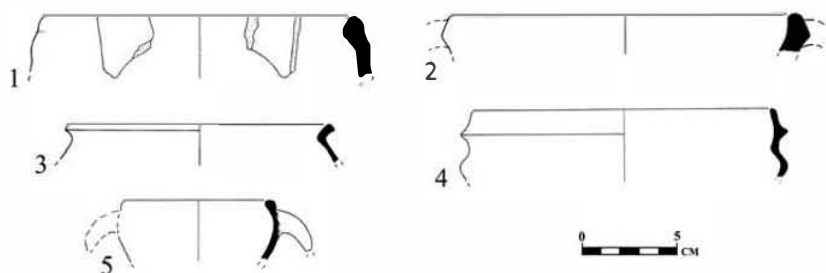
The site was excavated by Dror Ben-Yosef. For a detailed description of the excavations see Appendix C.



211. Yafit (3), view to the east. Note the 'processional way' encircling the site.



212. The 'processional way' of Yafit (3) prior to the excavation.



213. Pottery from Yafit (3), all IA I: 1-2. Kraters, dk brn; 3-4. CPs, dk brn; 5. Jar, lt brn.

Pottery: Iron I – 30%; Iron II – 18%; Late Roman – 42%; Middle Ages – 1%; Modern – 9%.

Flint: 24 items, Iron Age, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 106: 19-16/32/1

YAFIT (6)

Israel grid: 1937/1628

UTM grid: 7324/5497

Elevation: 190 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1.5 dunams (1500 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Rashash (181),
2 km distant

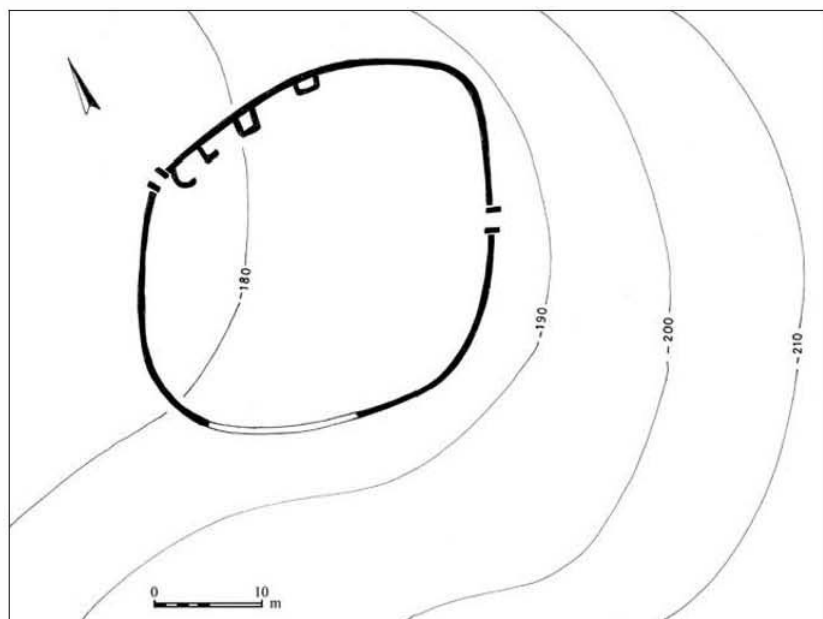
Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
500 m distant

Visit: March 1996; no sherds

An enclosure constructed in a ravine descending to Yafit Valley, about 1 km south-west of Yafit. There is a good view from the site to the Jordan Valley and to the nearby inner valley.

The enclosure is in a narrow valley. It is oval, well built from large and medium-sized stones, and measures 40×30 m. The wall is one stone wide – about 50 cm. In the eastern and north-western sides are built openings, 70 cm wide in average, between two standing monoliths.

Three small simple structures (*maq'ads*) were found attached to the north-western leg. Apparently, these structures are modern, and do not belong to the period of founding and occupation of the enclosure.



214. Plan of Yafit (6), 1996.

Pottery: none.

Flint: 7 items, undated, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 107: 19-16/32/2

YAFIT (2)

Israel grid: 1939/1625

UTM grid: 7326/5494

Elevation: 250 m b.s.l., 60 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: silt cover

Soil types: marl and silt

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Rashash (181),
1.8 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
next to the site

Visits: March 1996, 2005; 50 sherds

Two enclosures in the south-eastern margins of the Sartaba range, close to the alligator farm of Moshav Yafit, about 1 km south of the settlement.

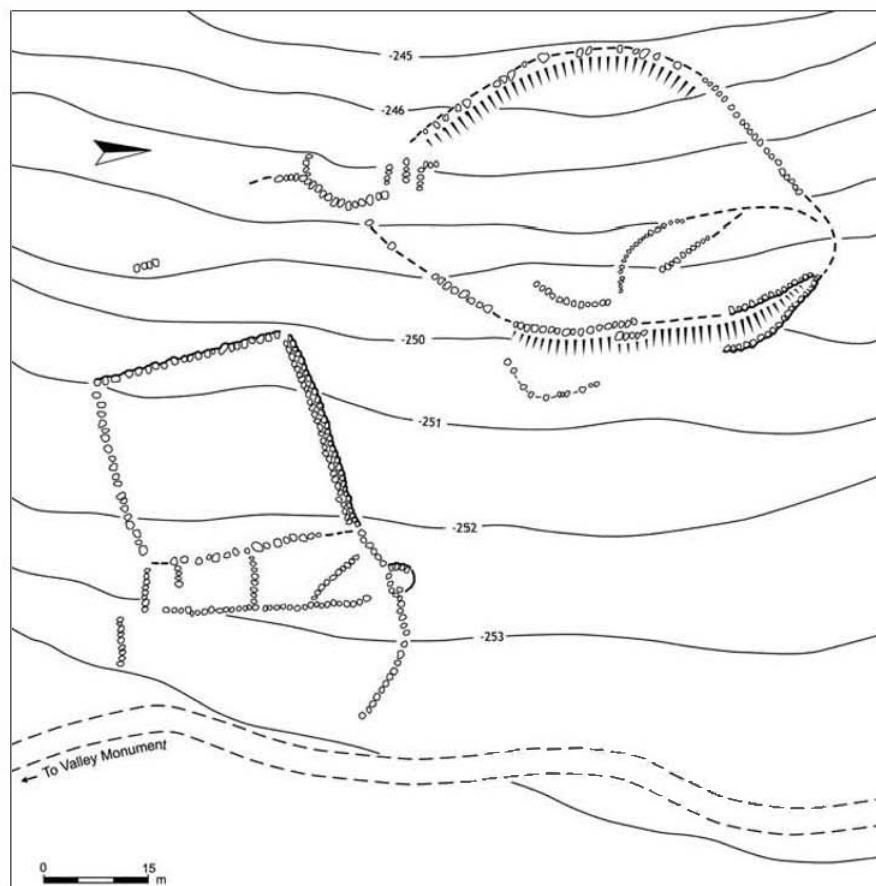
The eastern enclosure is a square courtyard, measuring 25×25 m, built of medium-sized stones. It is extended to the east by a semicircular courtyard, the diameter of which is about 30 m. Inside the semicircular courtyard were found remains of a small structure. The wall encircling this courtyard has been disturbed by the unpaved road leading to the Jordan Valley Monument.

The northern elongated enclosure is about 40 m long, and much damaged. It is built over two steps on the slope, with masonry of a single row of medium-sized stones. Additional wall remains were found in the southern part of this enclosure.

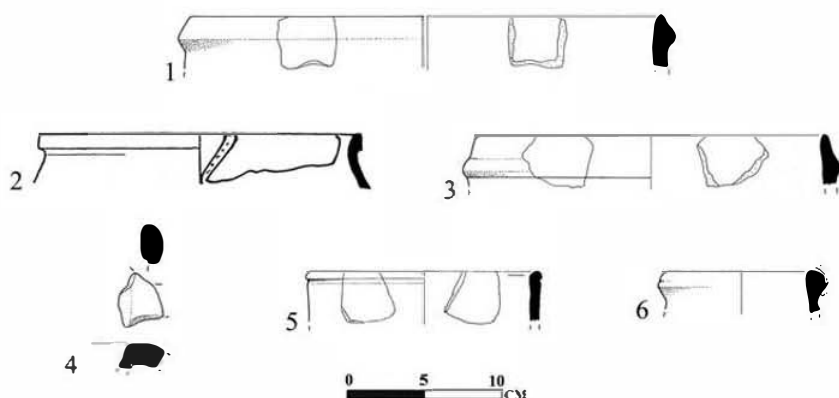
Pottery: Iron I – 32%; Late Roman – 68%.

Flint: 7 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



215. Plan of Yafit (2), 2005.



216. Pottery from Yafit (2):1-3. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 4-5. Jugs, buff, Ir I; 6. Jug, lt brn, LR.



Site 108: 19-16/32/4

YAFIT (1)

Israel grid: 1939/1623

UTM grid: 7326/5492

Elevation: 250 m b.s.l., 60 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: silt cover

Soil type: marl

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Rashash (181),
1.5 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
next to the site

Visit: March 1996; 8 sherds

A round enclosure in the south-eastern margins of the Sartaba range, close to and north-east of the Jordan Valley Monument.

This enclosure is about 50 m in diameter, and the perimeter wall is built of two rows of medium- and small-sized stones. No structures or walls were found inside the enclosure, and the pottery find is particularly poor.

Pottery: Iron I (?) – 37%; Late Roman – 63%.

Flint: 18 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Site 109: 19-16/32/5

YAFIT (5)

Israel grid: 1936/1625

UTM grid: 7323/5493

Elevation: 190 m b.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: large

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)

Topography: narrow valley

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

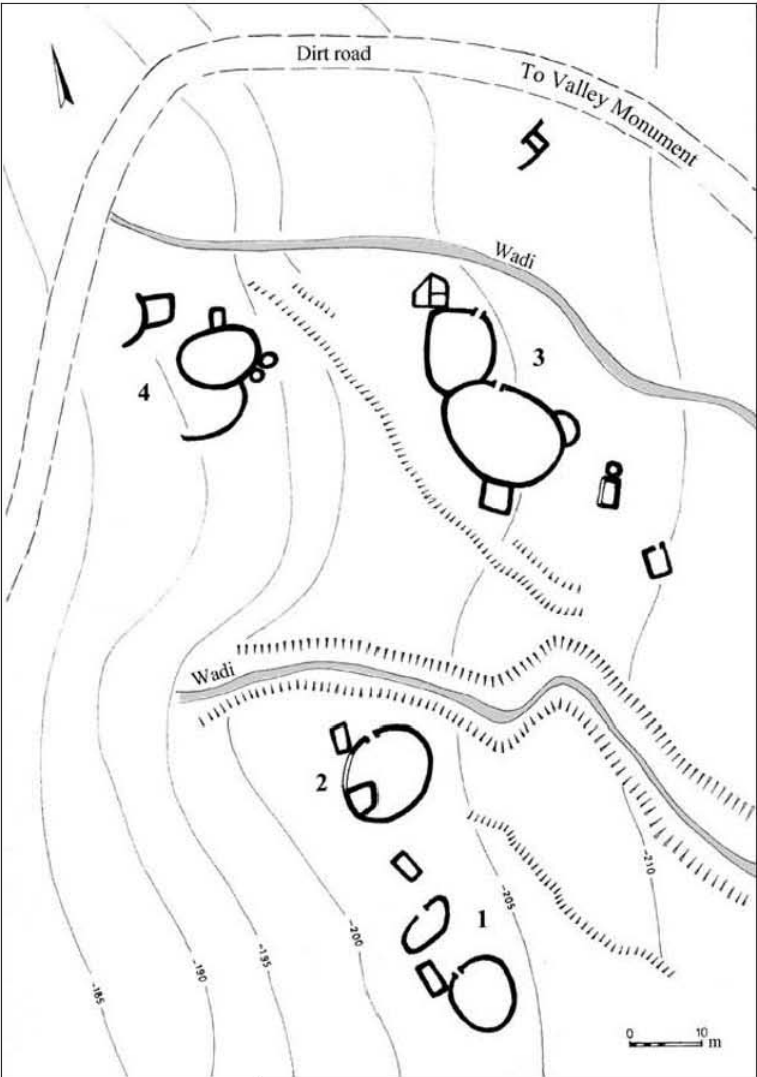
Water source: Wadi Rashash (181),
1.8 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
400 m distant

Visit: March 1996; 43 sherds

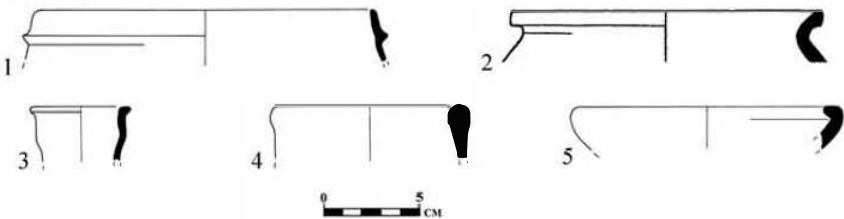
A large settlement in a narrow valley in the south-eastern margins of the Sartaba range, about 400 m north of the Jordan Valley Monument, and 1.2 km south-west of Moshav Yafit. From the site is a view eastward to the Yafit Valley and to the Jordan Valley.

In the valley where the site is located, an unpaved road ascends to E.P. -62 hill. The valley is dissected by ravines, and the dwelling complexes spread over small shoulders along these ravines. In the site are four similar complexes, each including round enclosures and dwelling structures. Following is their description, from south to north:

1. Two enclosures or courtyards, one round (10 m diameter), and the other oval (9 m maximum axis). Both have openings between two standing monoliths. Next to each one is a narrow rectangular structure, measuring about 5×2.5 m. These structures are standard throughout the site, and apparently served as dwellings.
2. An oval (11×10 m) courtyard, with a built entrance and an inner structure attached to its wall. Close to the courtyard, by the entrance, was a rectangular structure.
3. The largest complex: it has two oval courtyards attached to each other: the dimensions of the larger one are 16×12 m, and it has a built opening identical to those described above. Two structures are attached to the outside of this courtyard: a small square one and a semicircular one; both are 4–5 m in size. The second oval courtyard, about 10×8 in size, is attached to the north side of the larger one. Near its opening is a more complex structure, divided into three rooms. Two rectangular dwelling structures with openings were found about 10 m and 30 m south-east of the large courtyard; outside one of them is attached a round structure.



217. Plan of Yafit (5), 1996.



218. Pottery from Yafit (5), all IA I and are well fired: 1, 2. CPs, dk brn; 3. Jug, lt brn; 4. Jar, brn; 5. 'Manasseh' bowl, buff.

4. The north-western complex contains an oval courtyard (12×8 m) with two small circular and one rectangular structures attached to its outside. From the courtyard begins a curved wall, which was perhaps an additional courtyard, now dismantled or destroyed. Nearby to the west, are remains of another round courtyard with a large structure attached to it.

The number of sherds is small.

This large settlement is of special interest. Great effort was invested in its construction, and apparently it was used for dwelling and livestock husbandry. The small number of sherds perhaps suggests a seasonal settlement.

Pottery: Iron I-II – 90%; Late Roman – 10%.

Flint: 27 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: Bar-Adon 1972: site 12.



Site 110: 19-16/32/6

'MONUMENT' (1)

Israel grid: 1937/1624

UTM grid: 7327/5493

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: prehistoric

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Rashash (181),
1.2 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
400 m distant

Visit: March 2002, 2012.

A site, almost completely destroyed, on the spur where the Jordan Valley Monument is located, 1.5 km south-west of Moshav Yafit.

The site is located on a fairly high prominent spur, projecting south-eastward from the southern edge of the Sartaba range. This was part of the large Middle Palaeolithic site complex on the low southern slope of the EP-62 hill (see Sites 203-204). The only part of the site that survived modern destruction is located between the monument itself and the modern Jordan Valley amphitheatre, where flints are scattered in large quantities on the slope.

Additional surveys: none.

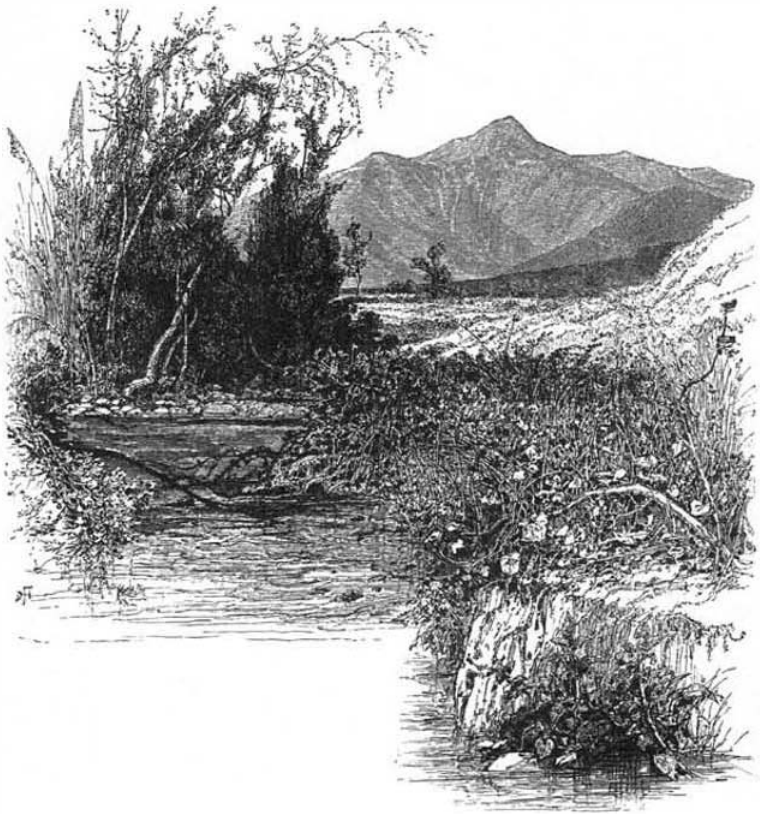


219. Monument (1), view to the east, 2003 (M. Einav). The site is located on the slope between the monument and the modern amphitheatre.

CHAPTER SIX

THE SARTABA RANGE
AND ITS SURROUNDINGS

LANDSCAPE UNIT 30



220. The Sartaba cone, viewed from the Jordan, engraving (Wilson 1880).

Site III: 19-17/15/1

WADI EL-BUTMEH

Israel grid: 1913/1751

UTM grid: 7297/5619

Elevation: 7● m a.s.l., 1● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: courtyard

Area: 1● dunams (1 ha)

Topography: spur

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
2.3 km distantRoad: Shechem–Jiftlik (B3),
2.4 km distant

Visit: April 1994; 122 sherds

A courtyard and threshing floors on a spur at the margins of Wadi el-Butmeh, 1 km east-north-east of Moshav Mekhora.

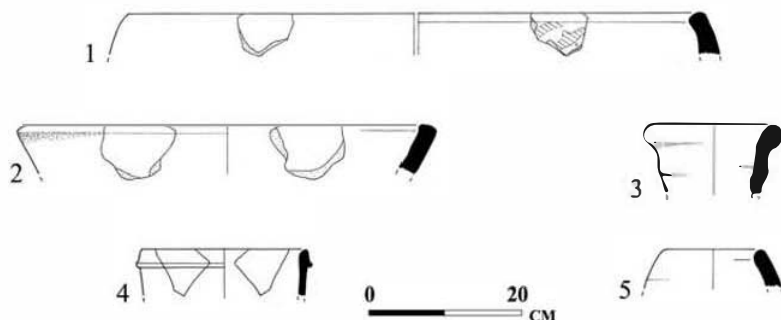
The spur borders on the east side of the deep Wadi el-Butmeh. On this particularly rocky spur are remains of a courtyard and several threshing floors, destroyed by modern agricultural activities. These structures and facilities may have been part of the larger site nearby to the west – Khirbet el-Butmeh (Site 112).

Pottery: Late Roman – 5●%; Middle Ages – 5●%.

Flint: 4 items, see Appendix A.

Stone: two grinding stones (see Eitam 2●●5: 695).

Additional surveys: none.



221. Pottery from Wadi el-Butmeh: 1. Krater, gr, yel glazing inside, MA; 2. Bowl, buff, MA; 3. Jug, brn, MA; 4. Jar, lt brn, LR; 5. Jug, buff, MA.

Site 112: 19-17/15/2

KHIRBET EL- BUTMEH

Israel grid: 1913/1750	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 7298/5618	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 50 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 1
Name: nearest place	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
Site type: farm	2.2 km distant
Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)	Road: Shechem–Jiftlik (B3),
Topography: spur at valley margins	2.3 km distant
Rock type: Avdat Group	Visit: April 1994; 80 sherds
Soil type: terra rossa	

A large site on a spur in the northern margins of the Mekhora Valley. From the site is a good view to Wadi Far'ah and its sites. Wadi el-Butmeh passes south of it, turns north and ends in a steep slope.

The site consists of three parts:

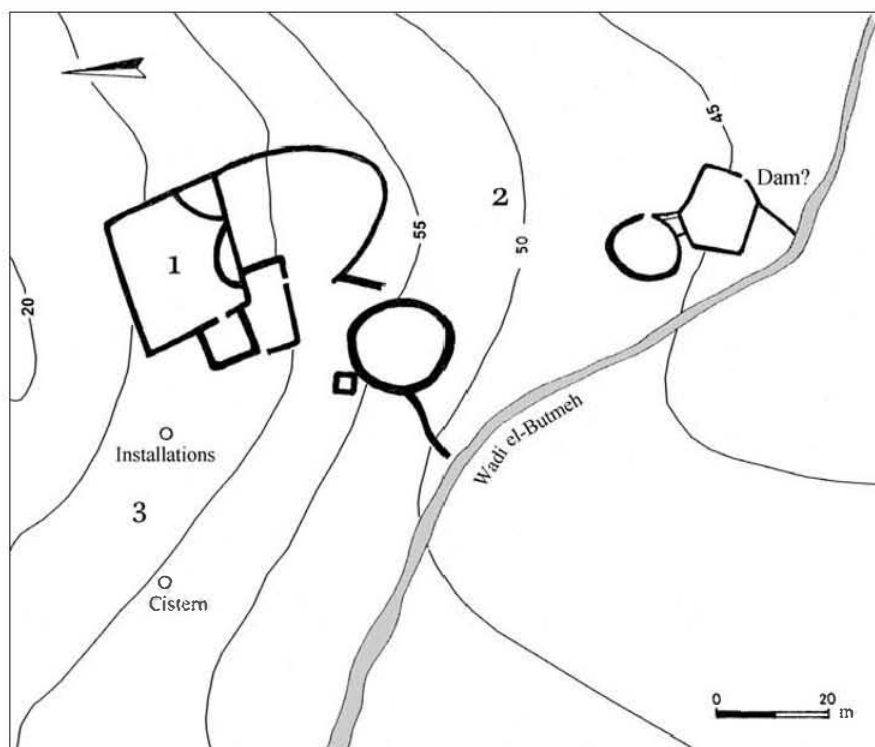
1. The western complex is the largest and most important. In its centre is a square courtyard 25×25 m, built of large uncut stones. Two structures are attached to the south-western corner of the courtyard, measuring 10×10 m and 15×8 m, also built of large stones. The rectangular structure has an opening connecting it to another courtyard. Apparently these structures were built later than the original courtyard.
2. Down the spur, in the direction of Wadi el-Butmeh, are three round courtyards, 15-20 m in diameter. Two of them are encircled by a stone wall about 2 m thick. From these two courtyards walls extend towards the stream channel; perhaps serving as dams.
3. Close to the large courtyard were found rock-cut installations, a cistern and a circular threshing floor.

The site is mentioned by Ilan (1973: 378): "An animal pen was surveyed on the other side of Wadi el-Butmeh, on the hillside. There is a large square courtyard in the site, with rooms attached to it on the south-east. In the place were found sherds from the Israelite, Roman, Early Arab and Medieval periods."

Apparently this was a farm, the inhabitants of which subsisted on lands in the Mekhora Valley; it is also possible that it had a link to Wadi Far'ah as a water source. The site in Wadi el-Butmeh (Site 111) was probably a part of this farm.

Pottery: Iron II – 31%; Late Roman – 56%; Middle Ages – 13%.

Additional surveys: none.



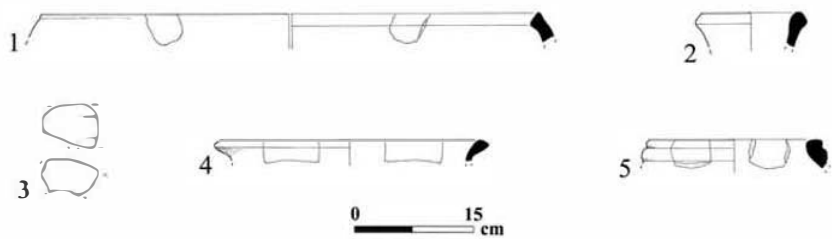
222. Plan of Khirbet el-Butmeh, 1994.



223. Aerial view of Khirbet el-Butmeh, to the north-east, 2013 (A. Solomon).



224. Khirbet el-Butmeh, the wall of the central courtyard, view to the south-west, 1994. Notice the construction with especially large stones. Standing: the late Nivi Mirkam.



225. Pottery from Khirbet el-Butmeh: 1. Krater, buff, Ir II; 2. Jug, brn, LR; 3. Jar handle, LR; 4. Bowl, buff, LR; 5. CP, dk brn, Ir II.

Site 113: 19-17/25/1

KITFET EL-'USIYEH

Israel grid: 1921/175●

UTM grid: 73●5/5619

Elevation: 1●● m b.s.l., 7● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures

Area: 2 dunams (2●●● sq. m)

Topography: shoulder

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

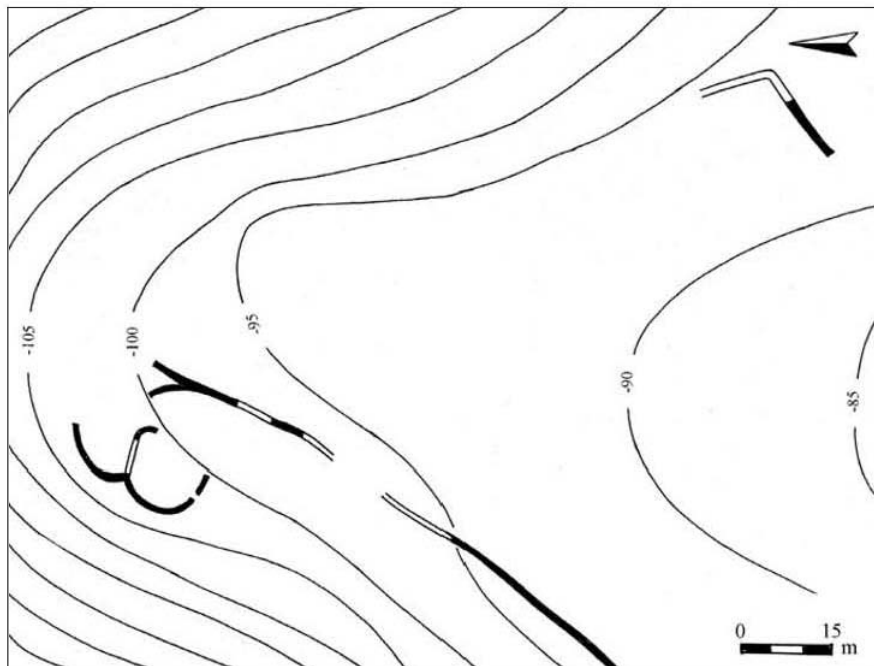
Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
1.6 km distantRoad: Shechem–Jiftlik (B3),
1.7 km distant

Visits: April 1994, May 2●●1; 75 sherds

An encampment site on a narrow shoulder above Wadi Far'ah, about 2 km east of Mekhora.

In the northern part of the shoulder is a double enclosure. The diameter of each of the two parts is 13 to 2● m, and they are built of medium-sized stones. The northern one has been less well preserved than the other.

In the centre of the shoulder are wall remains, from which a wall, about



226. Plan of Kitef el-'Usiyeh, 2001.



227. The western courtyard at Kitef el-'Usiyeh, view to the south, 1998.

70 m long, stretches out to the south-east. A moderate sherd scatter covers the area.

Pottery: Iron II – 27%; Late Roman – 64%; Byzantine – 4%; Modern – 5%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 114: 19-17/14/1

E.P. 103

Israel grid: 1914/1742

UTM grid: 7298/5611

Elevation: 95 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: structure and enclosures

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: broad hilltop

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
3 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C38),
1.5 km distant

Visits: April 1994, Nov. 2001; 64 sherds

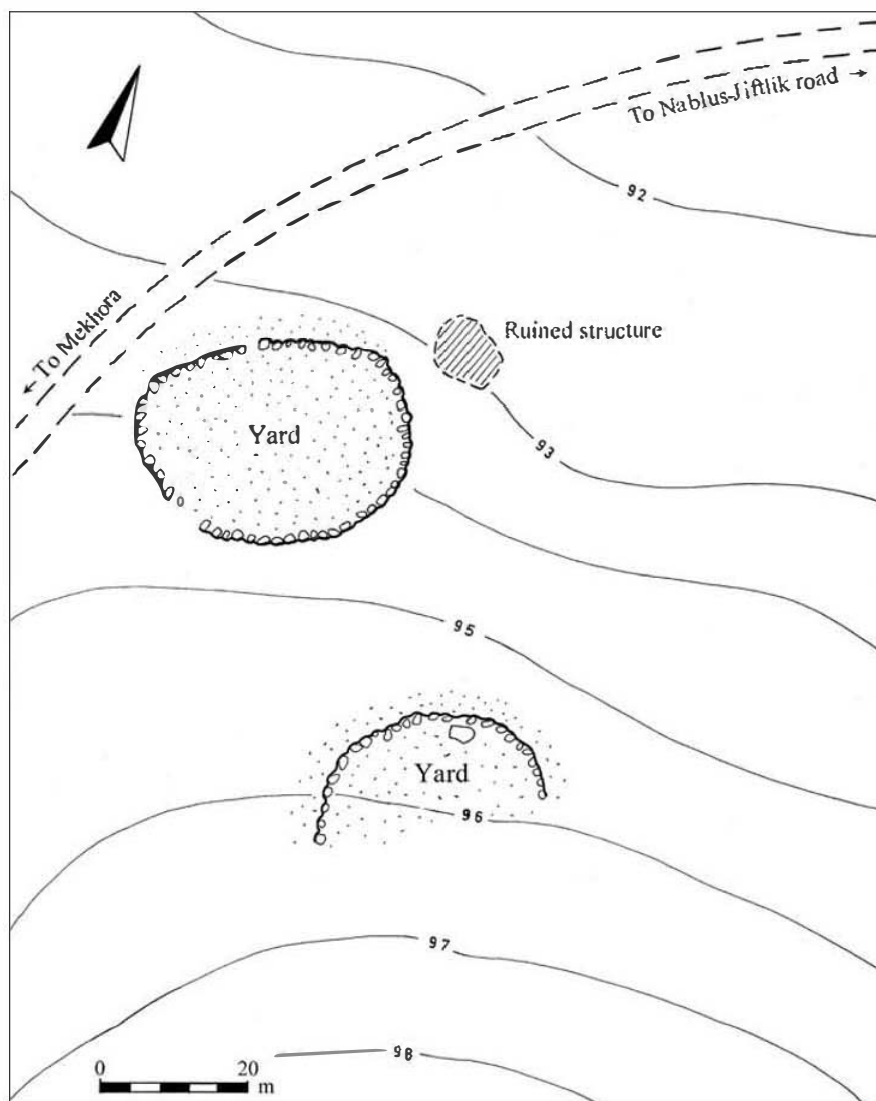
A structure and two enclosures on a broad hilltop in the north-eastern margins of the Mekhora Valley. From the hilltop is a good view to the valley and to the Sartaba range.

The central structure measures about 4×4 m, and is covered by a heap of stones: attached to it is a round enclosure, about 20 m in diameter. About 30 m to the south-east is another structure about 15 m in diameter. The construction is simple. By the central structure is a tumulus-like heap of stones.

Pottery: Iron II – 24%; Late Roman – 76%.

Flint: 3 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.





229. Pottery from E.P.103: 1-2. Jar and jug, lt brn, LR.



Site 115: 18-17/93/1

JORET EL-KARAIREH

Israel grid: 1899/1734

UTM grid: 7283/56●2

Elevation: 23● m a.s.l., 1● m a.s.a.

Name: in the map

Site type: farm, courtyards,
installations and prehistoric

Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)

Topography: low spur in valley
margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: 'Ein el-Foqa (173),
1.6 km distant

Road: Jiftlik-Ṭana (C38), 1 km distant

Visit: April 1994; 9● sherds

A large site on a broad spur at the western margins of the Mekhora Valley, overlooking the valley and the road to Gittit. It is 1 km south of Mekhora in the eastern margins of E.P. 247.

There is a developed complex of farms, courtyards, livestock pens, threshing floors and rock-cut agricultural installations in the site. The central structure is a square courtyard measuring 25×25 m. It is built of large stones, with the entrance on the north side. Apparently, some time after its construction, the courtyard was divided into secondary units by walls of small stones, making three spaces, the functions of which are not clear.

About 35 m north of this unit is an irregular courtyard, whose construction is inferior to that of the central one.

North of these elements, along the spur, are two circular threshing floors, about 15 m in diameter. West and south of the courtyards and the threshing floors are six concentrations of rock-cut installations, among them basins, craters, and various structures (see details in Eitam 2005: 698–708).

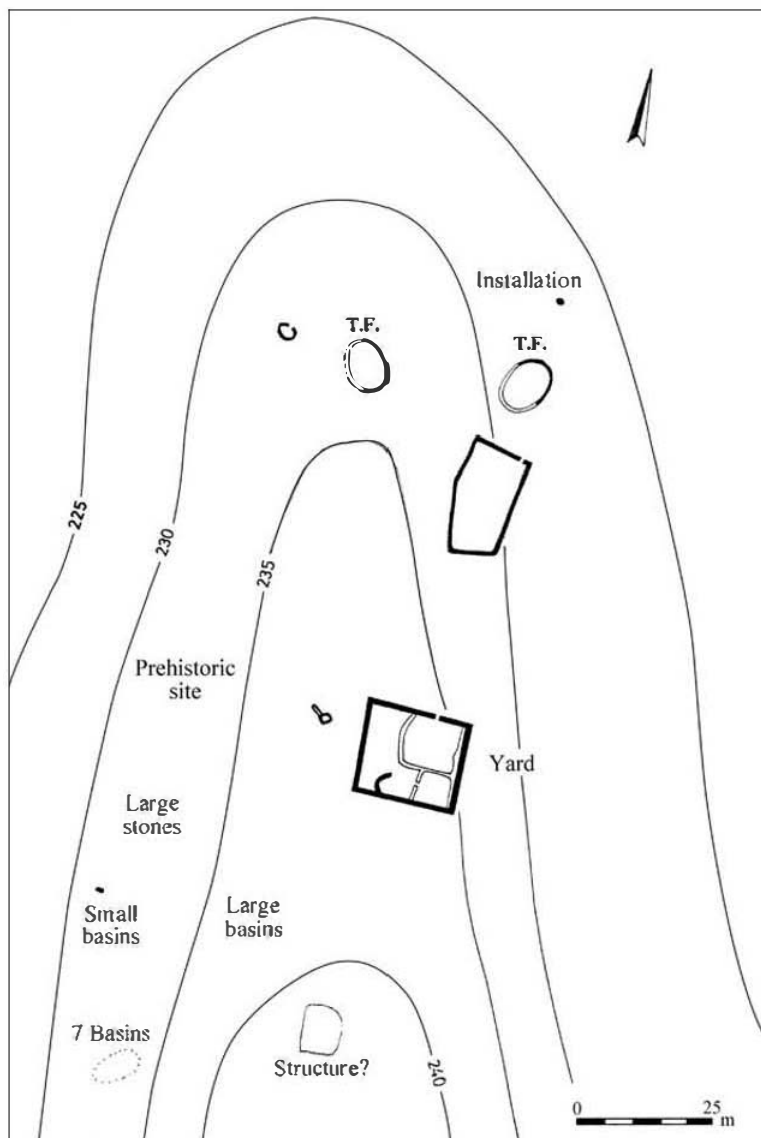
South of the large courtyard, on the top of the spur, is a structure covered by cleared stones. On the west side is a pile of large stones, perhaps used for construction.

In the north-eastern corner of the spur, close to the unpaved road from Mekhora, is a stone circle 2● m in diameter with a heap of stones in the middle

(not on the plan).

In the western part of the spur, adjacent to the many and varied installations found, many flint items were collected. These belong to an Epipalaeolithic site that was also discovered here (see Appendix A).

In the site of Joret el-Karaireh was a farm and a concentration of installations for the processing of agricultural produce of various types (wine and cereals). A developed complex, such as this one, is rather rare.



230. Plan of Joret el-Karaireh, 1994.



231. Aerial view of the central courtyard at Joret el-Karaireh, 1997 (M. Einav).

Pottery: Iron II – 2●%; Late Roman – 3●%; Byzantine – 48%; Middle Ages – 2%.

Flint: 2●6 items, Epipalaeolithic, see Appendix A.

Installations: more than 6● installations of various types were found in the western part of the spur. Some belonged to the Epipalaeolithic site, and others to the IA and Rom-Byz agricultural structures. For additional details see the report by Eitam (2●●5: 698–7●8).

Additional surveys: none.



Site 116: 19-17/03/1

MUGHUR EL-'AVDAT

Israel grid: 19●9/1737

UTM grid: 7294/56●6

Elevation: 1●● m a.s.l., 3● m a.s.a.

Name: ancient and on map

Site type: courtyards

Area: 1 dunam (1●●● sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

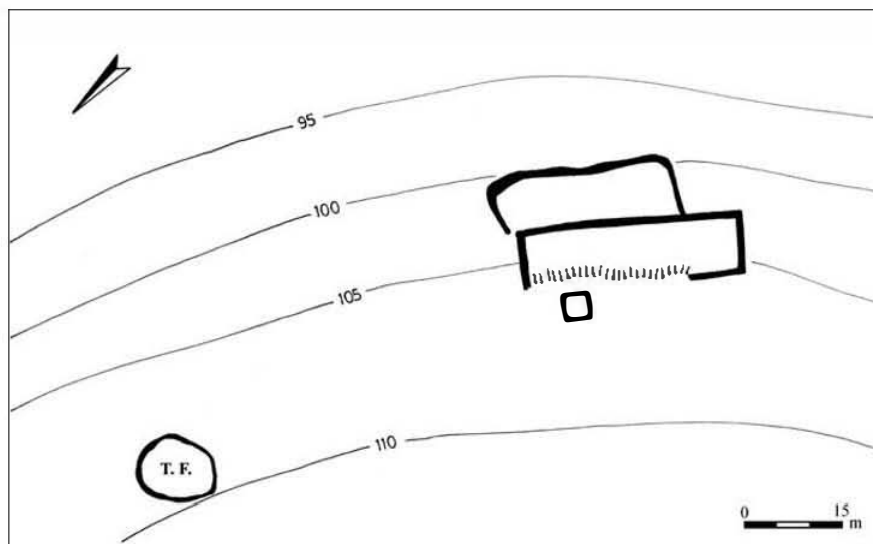
Water source: 'Ein el-Foqa (173),
2.6 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C38),
1.5 km distant

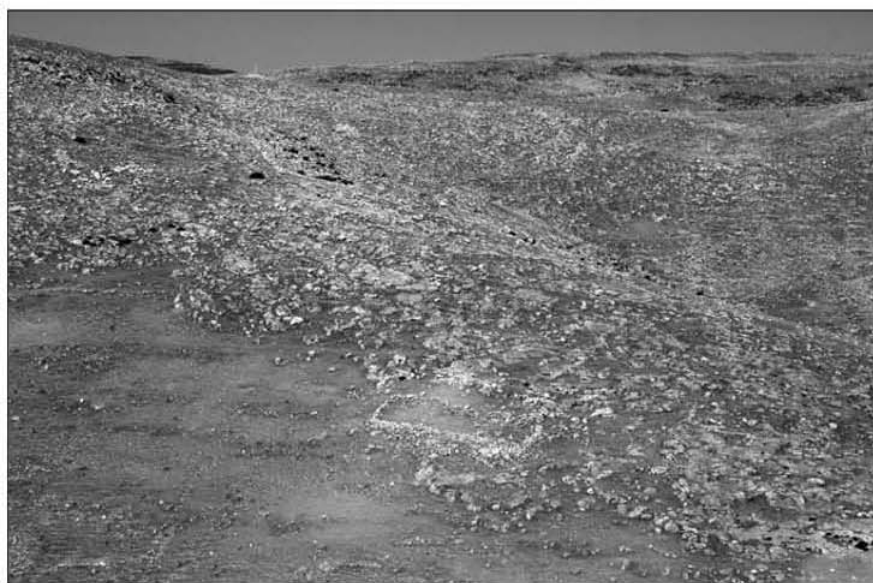
Visit: April 1994; 65 sherds

A site on the south-eastern slope of the Mughur el-'Avdat spur, in the western margins of the Mekhora Valley, about 1 km south-east of Mekhora, and with a fine view of the Mekhora Valley.

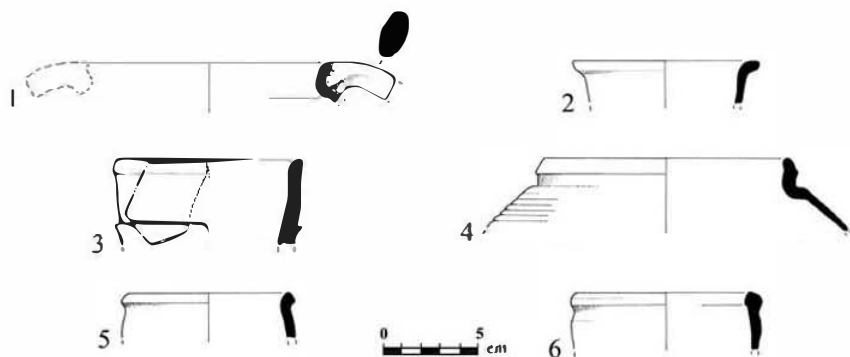
There are two similar courtyards on the slope, one above the other. The dimensions of the upper one are about 30×9 m: its walls are straight and are



232. Plan of Mughur el-'Avdat, 1994.



233. Aerial view to the north-west of Mughur el-'Avdat, 2013 (A. Solomon).



234. Pottery of Mughur el-'Avdat: 1. Jar, lt brn, Ir II; 2. Jar, buff, LR; 3. Jug, buff, LR; 4. Jar, brn, Byz; 5-6. Jars, buff, Rom-Byz.

well built. The dimensions of the lower, south-eastern, courtyard are 25×8 m, and construction is of medium-sized stones. The walls, about 1 m thick, are preserved. In the lower courtyard are modern constructions.

At the top of the site is a dwelling unit, adjacent to a rock-hewn cave. About 60 m north of the courtyards is a threshing floor, about 12 m in diameter.

In this site, the sherds are much more numerous than in other similar farm sites.

Pottery: Iron II – 11%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 45%; Middle Ages – 24%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 116 (1): 19-17/03/2

DAM SITE

Israel grid: 1908/1732

UTM grid: 7292/5601

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name: by the survey team

Site type: dam

Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 6

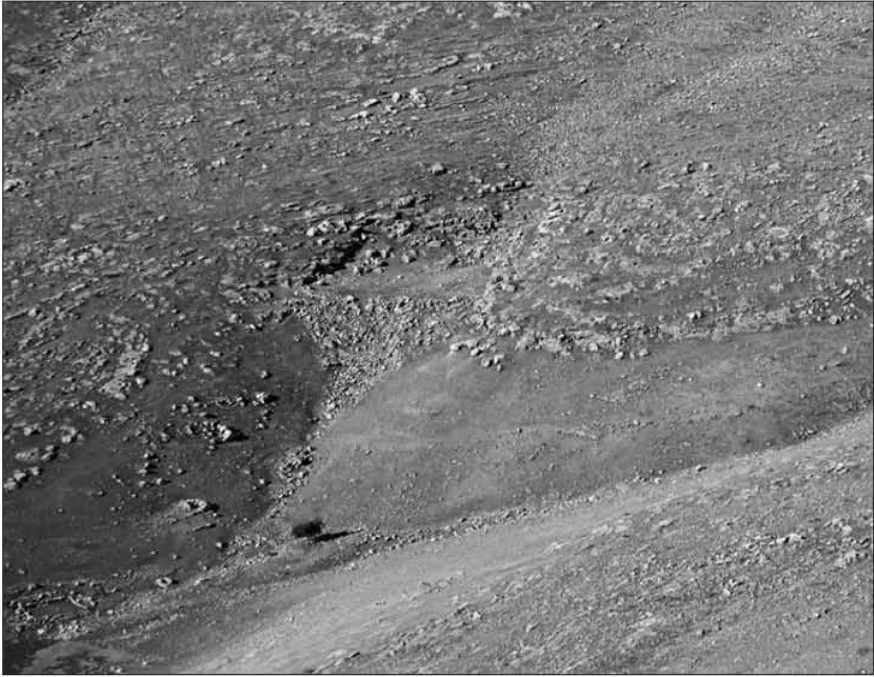
Cultivation: fields nearby

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein el-Foqa (173),
2.5 km distant

Road: Jiftlik-Tana (C38), 1.5 km distant

Visit: Nov. 2013, 2015; 30 sherds



235. Aerial view of the Dam Site, 2013 (A. Solomon).

A dam in a narrow ravine 1.5 km south-east of Mekhora.

This is an advanced agricultural installation that includes two dams that seal a nameless ravine to the east of E.P. 228.

The upper dam is 12 m wide and built of large stones. It survives to a height of 3 m, up to six stone courses. The lower dam, 40 m east of the upper dam, is 22 m wide and has a wall more than 1 m wide. The slope below this dam is filled with stone collapse. On both banks of the ravine, between the dams, are rock faces up to 3 m high that partly enclose the area for collecting water. This area is now filled with sediment eroded from the slopes above.

Near the site are many agricultural terraces.

This is a unique agricultural installation, probably dated to the LR period and re-used in the MA.

Pottery: Late Roman – 50%; Middle Ages – 50%.

Additional surveys: none.

Site 117: 19-17/13/1

EL-MEDAKAKIN

Israel grid: 1919/1738

UTM grid: 73●4/56●7

Elevation: 135 m a.s.l., ● m a.s.a.

Name: on map but not as ancient site

Site type: farm and prehistoric

Area: 1 dunam (1●●● sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (1●4),
2.5 km distant

Road: Jiftlik-Tana (C38), 1 km distant

Visit: March 1994; 62 sherds

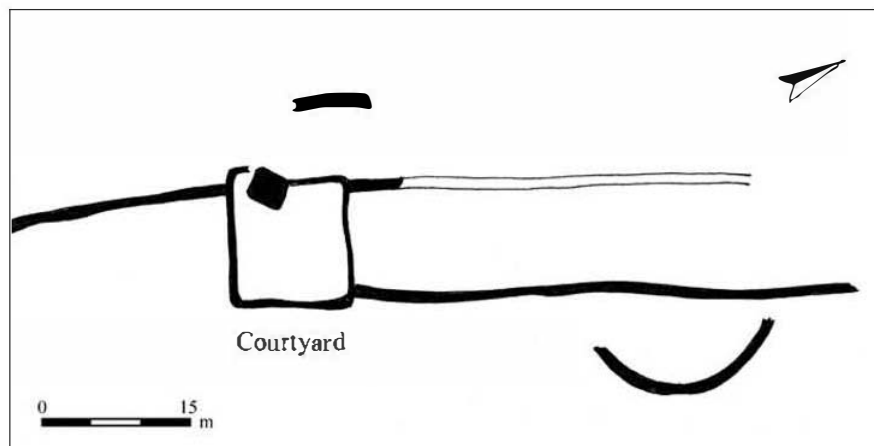
A farm in the eastern part of the el-Medakakin hilltop, about 2 km south-east of Mekhora. The hilltop is notably broad and the site is on its eastern side which looks out to Wadi Far'ah.

There is a central ruined structure, measuring 4×4 m, built of large uncut stones. Attached to it is an almost square courtyard built of large stones, measuring 15×13 m. Large stones, fallen from the courtyard wall, are scattered around.

Terrace walls project from the structure and the courtyard to form narrow spaces or fields to north and south. The larger northern field is about 4●×12 m. East of its wall is another, semicircular, terrace.

Sherds were found only in the courtyard.

This is a typical farm, founded in the 1A and re-utilized during the Rom Period.



236. Plan of el-Medakakin, 1994.



237. El-Medakakin, general view to the west, 1994. The person is in the central structure.

In the slope south-west of the site Hovers and Bar-Yosef (1987: 79), reported a Middle Palaeolithic Mousterian flint scatter (1917/1737).

Pottery: Iron II – 20%; Late Roman – 80%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 118: 19-17/13/2

UMM SAWANEH (1)

Israel grid: 1917/1731

UTM grid: 7301/5600

Elevation: 40 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: shoulder above valley

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

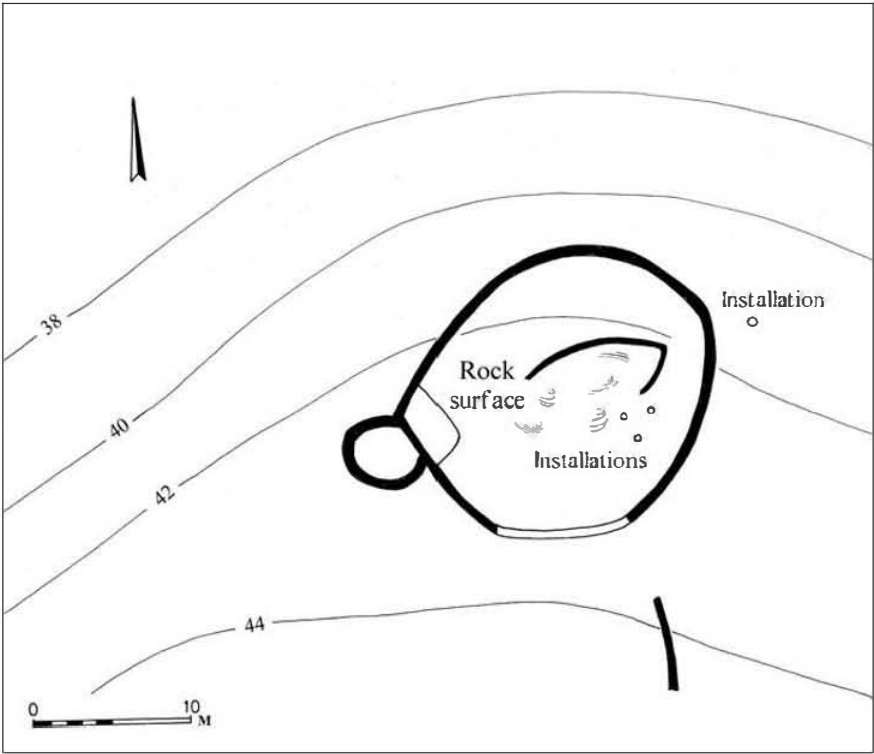
Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
3.2 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C38),
400 m distant

Visit: May 1994; 42 sherds

A site on a slope at the Umm Sawaneh ridge, about 2 km south-east of Mekhora, and close to the junction of one of the tributaries of Wadis Zeith and edh-Dhba'ah.



238. Plan of Umm Sawaneh (1), 1994.



239. Umm Sawaneh (1), view to the north, 1994.

There is an oval courtyard in the site, 20×18 m, built of large stones. Attached to it on the west is a small round structure, 5 m in diameter. Two building phases are visible: the earlier is of large stones, and the later is of medium-sized stones. The linkage of the building stages to the periods defined by the pottery is unclear.

Three basins are cut into a rock surface in the middle of the courtyard. Outside the courtyard to the south-east is another cut basin and recesses.

Pottery: Iron II – 14%; Late Roman – 86%.

Installations: 4 basins were found, probably cut in the IA and re-used in the LR period (Eitam 2005: 708).

Additional surveys: none.



Site 119: 18-17/92/1

E.P. 236

Israel grid: 1896/1723

UTM grid: 7281/5591

Elevation: 220 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: spur margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein el-Foqa (173),
2 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Ṭana (C35/38),
next to the site

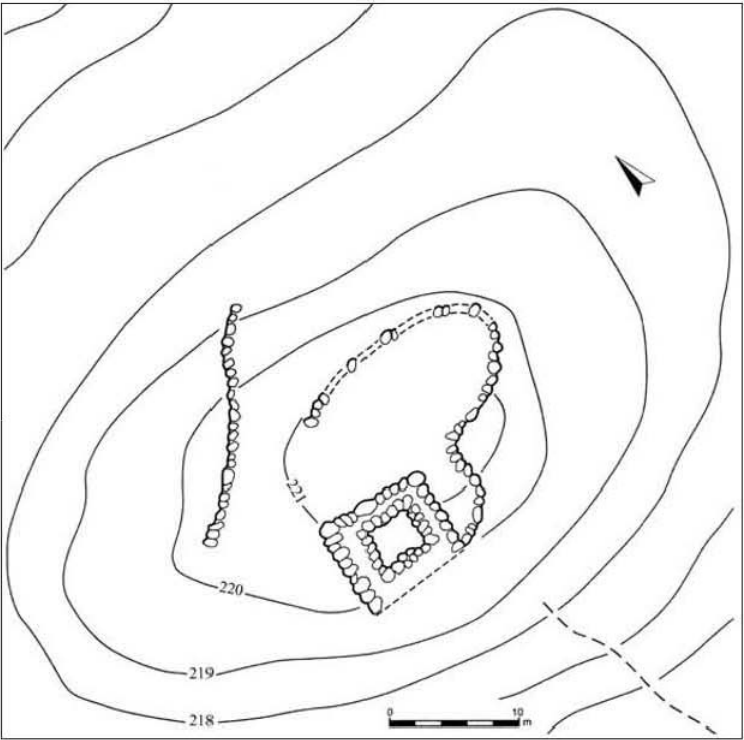
Visit: June 1994; 42 sherds

A structure and courtyard in the southern margins of the Joret el-Karaireh spur, south of E.P. 236 hilltop and 2 km south of Mekhora. The site overlooks the Roman road (C35/38), from the Jiftlik to Khirbet Ṭane and Neapolis, and the modern Alon Road which passes down the wadi to the west.

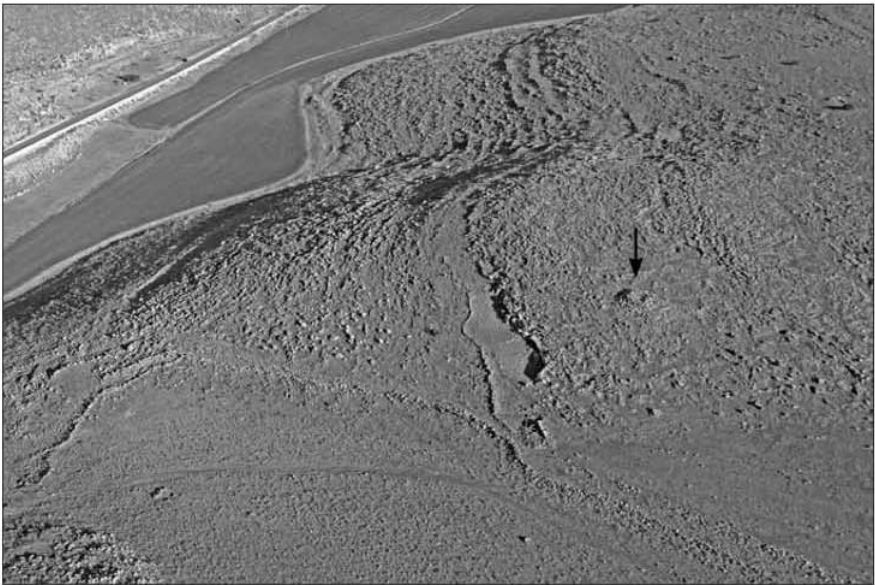
The structure is almost square, 7×7 m, and is built of medium-sized stones. The walls are about 1 m thick and now stand 1.5 m high. Originally it was built as a tower over a double podium, the bottom storey supporting the upper one. A jamb stone with a bolt recess in it lies next to the structure.

An irregular courtyard is attached to the structure on the north-east. The courtyard wall is one stone thick (50 cm).

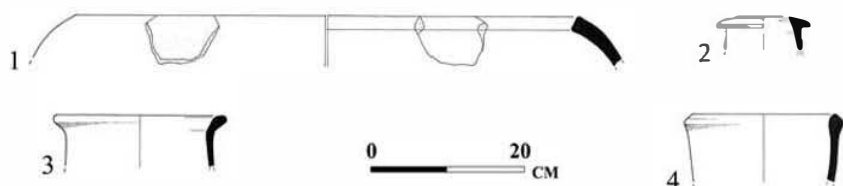
North-west of the structure is a terrace wall about 20 m long, and next to it is a karstic recess in the rock which served as a trough to water livestock.



240. Plan of the Roman fort at E.P. 236, 1994.



241. Aerial view of E.P. 236, 2013 (A. Solomon). Note the Roman road in the inner valley and the edge of the rocky slope below the site.



242. Pottery from E.P. 236, all LR: 1. Krater, brn; 2. Juglet, cream; 3-4. Jars, lt brn.

Ilan and Damati (1975: 46) described it thus: "About 50 m north of the road, which crosses the shoulder, and above it are nice remains of a Roman fort."

The design of the complex resembles that of other sites along the Roman roads in the region. Its layout is similar to the sites in E.P. 280 (Site 133) and Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (3) (Site 131). They probably all served as watch towers along the road.

Pottery: Late Roman – 100%.

Installations: 5 basins and 2 cupmarks were found, dated to the LR period (Eitam 2005: 708-709).

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Ilan 1973: 292.



Site 120: 19-17/02/2

WADI EDH-DHBA'AH (4)

Israel grid: 1900/1722

UTM grid: 7285/5591

Elevation: 160 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: cave and courtyards

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

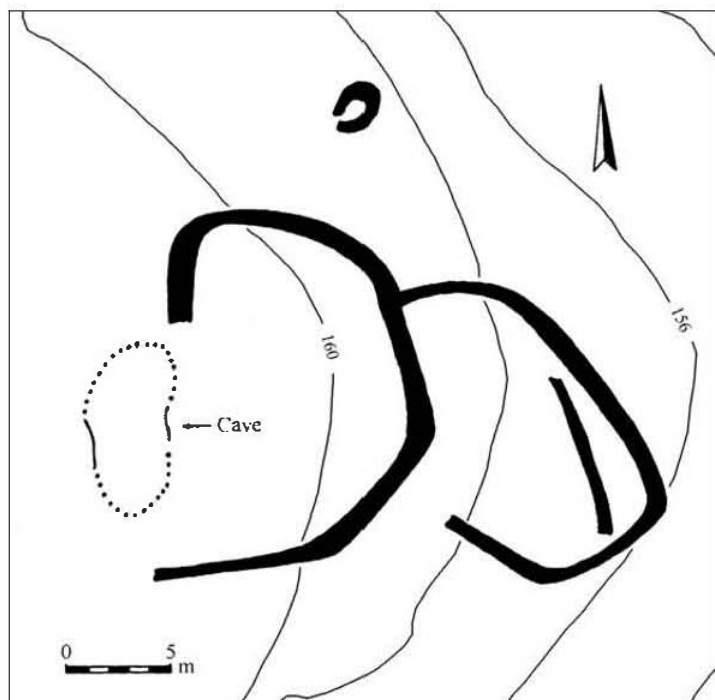
Water source: 'Ein el-Foqa (173),
2.4 km distant

Road: Jiftlik-Ṭana (C35/38),
next to the site

Visit: June 1994; 37 sherds

Courtyards and a cave over the eastern slope facing Wadi edh-Dhba'ah, in the low south-eastern part of the spur of Joret el-Karaireh. From the site there is a limited view of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah and the unpaved road on its western slope. Close by the site to the south is the Roman Jiftlik-Ṭana road (C35/38).

There are two courtyards in the site, one above the other:



243. Plan of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (4), 1994.



244. The eastern wall of the upper courtyard in Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (4) site, view to the north, 1994.

1. The upper courtyard is oval, measuring 14×11 m: its eastern wall has been preserved to a height of about 2 m. The initial construction was of large stones, on top of which middle-sized stones were added later in order to raise the wall. The wall was repaired with middle-sized stones, indicating its prolonged use. In the western part the courtyard walls meet the cave, which is about 7 m wide and 4 m deep.
2. Only one course of medium-sized stones remains from the lower courtyard. The yard is oval, and it abuts the upper courtyard in the north-west. Its south-western part has not been preserved.

North of the courtyards is a small round stone structure whose function is uncertain.

This site is unusual in the region, being founded in the Byz period and not being preceded by an Iron Age settlement.

Pottery: Byzantine – 65%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages (Mamluk) – 20%; Modern – 10%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 121: 19-17/02/1

WADI EDH-DHBA'AH (1)

Israel grid: 1901/1723

UTM grid: 7286/5591

Elevation: 120 m a.s.l., 100 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: courtyard and agricultural installations

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: steep slope at the margins of a valley

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein el-Foqa (173), 2.5 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35/38), 400 m distant

Visit: May 1994; 35 sherds

A courtyard, terraces and a threshing floor in a deep valley, a tributary of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah, about 2 km south of Mekhora.

The site is on a steep slope; in its northern part is a square courtyard, measuring about 25×25 m, built of one row of particularly large stones. In the southern

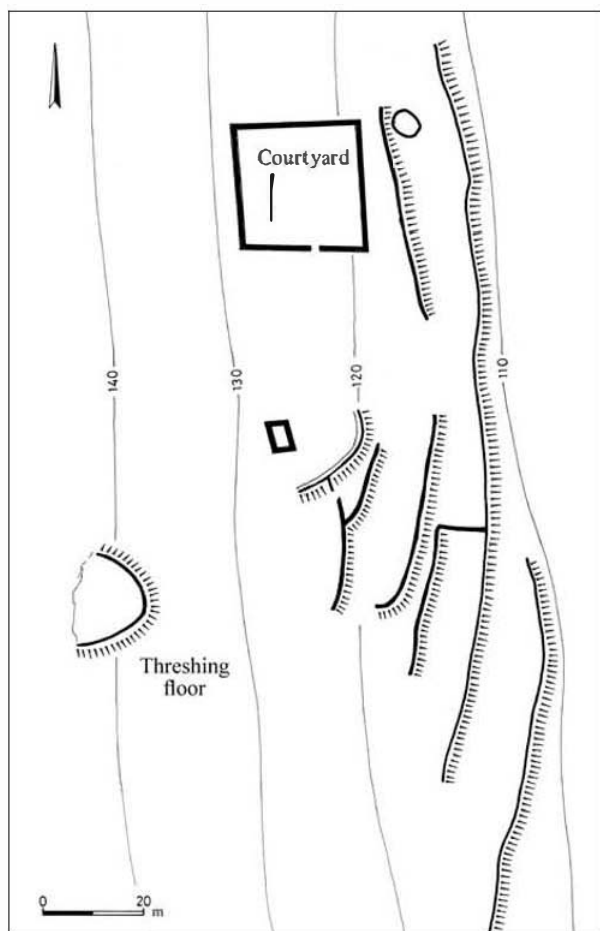
wall of the courtyard is an entrance, and in its inner upper part are the remains of another wall.

South and east of the courtyard are terraces 1–2 m high built on the slope. These long terraces were built to stabilize the courtyard, among other purposes. Further up the slope is a threshing floor; a semicircle about 15 m in diameter, built of large stones, resting on the slope and protruding from it. Between the threshing floor and the courtyard is a ruined structure, also built of large stones.

The terraces, and perhaps also the threshing floor, should apparently be related to the 1A II site. A typical Rom-Byz square courtyard was constructed later.

Pottery: Iron II – 60%; Late Roman – 33%; Ottoman – 7%.

Additional surveys: none.



245. Plan of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (1), 1994.



246. Aerial view of the courtyard in Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (1), view to the south-east, 1997 (M. Einav).



247. The south wall of the courtyard at Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (1), view to the west, 1994.

Site 122: 19-17/02/3

WADI EDH-DHBA'AH (2)

Israel grid: 1903/1720	Soil type: brown forest
UTM grid: 7288/5589	Soil quality: 6
Elevation: 120 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: none
Name: nearest place	Cisterns: 1
Site type: courtyard and threshing floors	Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177), 2.2 km distant
Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)	Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35/38), next to the site
Topography: slope at valley margins	Visit: May 1994; 75 sherds
Rock type: Avdat Group	

A courtyard, threshing floors and structures on a low shoulder, about 2 km south of Mekhora. The shoulder is close to a valley, and north of it is an inner cultivated medium-sized valley. This valley is the upper section of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah which descends northwards to Wadi Zeith.

In the lower part of the site, close to the valley, is a square courtyard built of large stones, measuring about 20×20 m; in the centre of which is a cave with two openings. Outside to the north, abutting the north-eastern corner of the yard, is a curved wall reaching the yard wall near the north-western corner. Judging from its construction this wall is a later addition to the original courtyard.

In the upper, southern, part of the site are three round threshing floors. The diameter of the western one is 15 m and its framing wall is built of large stones. The eastern one is curved and longer, and is open to the south.

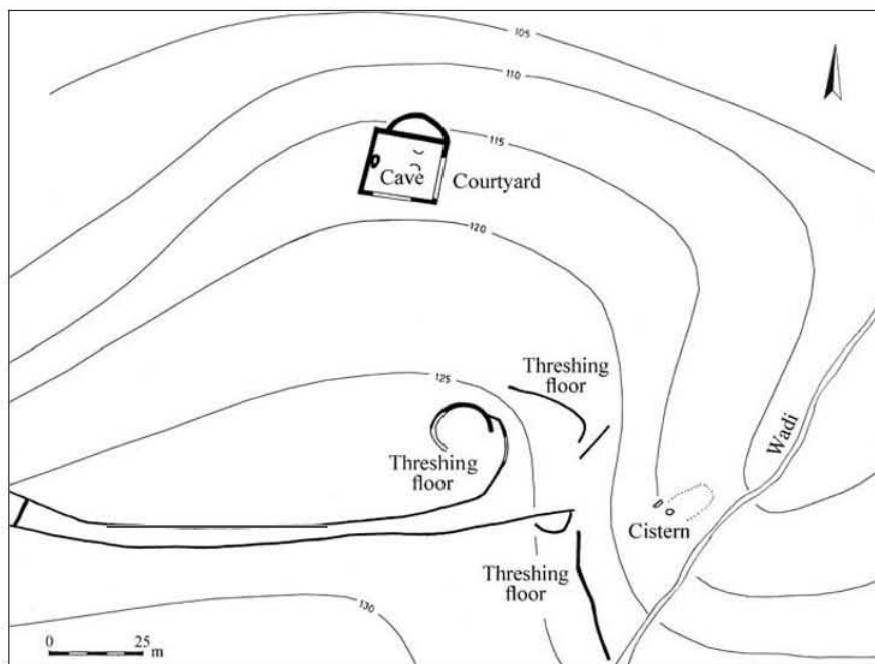
A built road 150 m long and 3–8 m wide leads from the first threshing floor. This floor, the route of which is marked by two stone walls, crosses the upper part of the shoulder. East of the road is a third threshing floor, with a wall descending from it through the valley to the Wadi edh-Dhba'ah channel. About 25 m down the channel is a rock-cut cistern with a rainwater collecting surface and a stone trough next to it.

This is a fine example of an agricultural centre, established in the IA and re-used during the LR period. Noteworthy is the built road, which possibly served for the movement of flocks and crops.

Pottery: Iron II – 61%; Late Roman – 30%; Middle Ages – 9%.

Installations: 4 cupmarks were found, dated to the IA period possibly re-used during the LR and MA periods (Eitam 2005: 710).

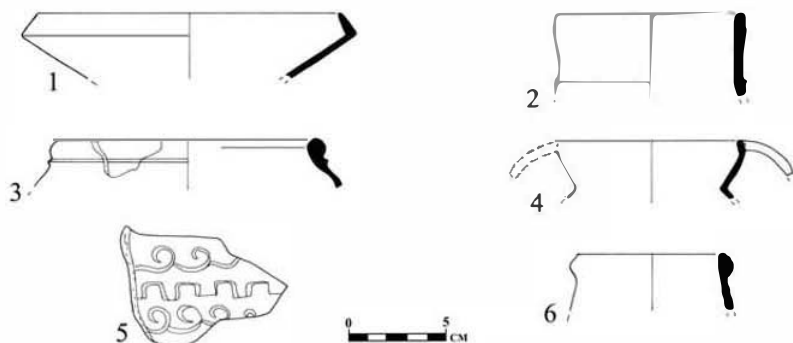
Additional surveys: none.



248. Plan of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (2), 1994.



249. Aerial view of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (2), view to the south, 1997 (M. Einav).



250. Pottery from Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (2): 1. Large bowl, gr, MA?; 2. Jar, lt brn, LR; 3. CP, dk brn, IA II; 4. Jug/CP, brn-rd, LR; 5. Dec sherd, violet over cream, MA (Mamluk); 6. Jar, brn, Rom.



Site 123: 19-17/●2/4

UMM SAWANEH (5)

Israel grid: 19●8/172●

UTM grid: 7293/5588

Elevation: 1●● m a.s.l., 3● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: prehistoric and installations

Area: 1 dunam (1●●● sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
2 km distant

Road: Jiflik-Tana (C38),
next to the site

Visits: May 1994, 2●●3

A prehistoric site in the eastern side of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah, west of and above the deep channel of Wadi Zeith.

There is a very large concentration of 15 cup-marks and 51 varied rock-cut installations on the rocky surface. More than 1●● flint items were collected near these installations.

Flint: 11 items, Epipalaeolithic, see Appendix A.

Installations: 15 cupmarks and 51 installations, dated to the Epipalaeolithic period (Eitam 2●●5: 71●-715).

Additional surveys: none.

Site 124: 19-17/22/1

UMM SAWANEH (4)

Israel grid: 192●/1729

UTM grid: 73●4/5598

Elevation: ● m a.s.l., 6● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: farm and cave

Area: 2.5 dunams (25●● sq. m)

Topography: slope and spur

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 5

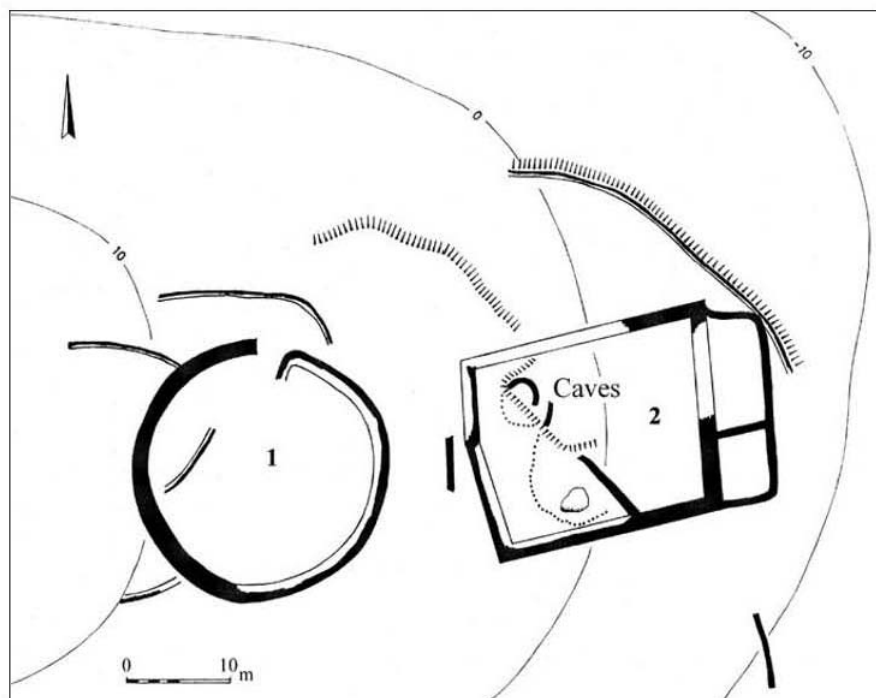
Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

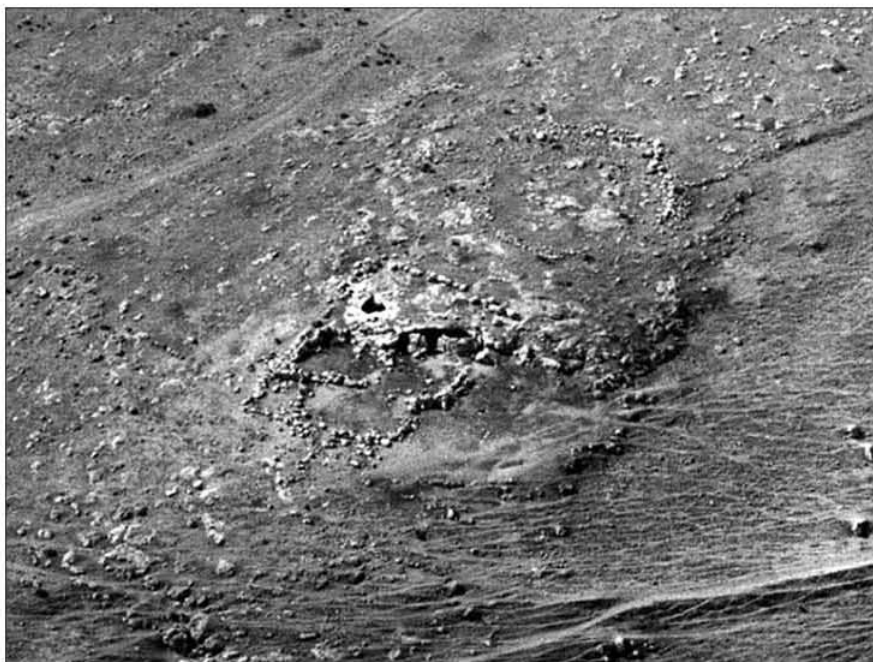
Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
3 km distantRoad: Jiftlik-Ṭana (C38), 3●● m
distant

Visit: May 1994; 119 sherds

A farm, enclosure and cave in the north-eastern part of the Umm Sawaneh ridge, at the top of a high narrow spur sloping to the deep Wadi Zeith. The site is 2.6 km south-east of Mekhora. There is a good view from the site to Wadi Zeith and its tributaries.



251. Plan of Umm Sawaneh (4), 1994.



252. Aerial view of Umm Sawaneh (4), view to the west, 1997 (M. Einav).



253. Umm Sawaneh (4): the cave and lower courtyard, view to the west, 1994 (S. Hashman).

There are two parts to the site:

In the upper one is a round enclosure about 20 m in diameter, built of large stones. The enclosure wall had two rows of stones, but its eastern lower part was washed away down the slope and only the foundation stones remain. IA II sherds were found, mainly scattered in and around the enclosure, and therefore it is possible that it was founded at that period.

In the lower eastern part of the site is a rectangular courtyard, measuring 21×18 m, also built of large stones. The wall, built of two rows of stones, is about 1.2 m thick. To the lower eastern wall of the courtyard are attached two elongated rooms. It seems that their construction is later than the yard itself. In the western upper part of the courtyard is a rock face about 2 m high with cave openings. Next to one of the openings walls were built to create an entrance.

Both enclosures are supported by a terrace wall built into the slope. Around the whole area is a considerable sherd scatter, testifying to prolonged utilization of the site.

Pottery: Iron II – 32%; Late Roman – 28%; Byzantine – 30%; Early Moslem – 3%; Modern – 7%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 125: 19-17/12/1

UMM SAWANEH (2)

Israel grid: 1911/1726

UTM grid: 7296/5595

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures and sherd scatter

Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)

Topography: broad hilltop

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),

3 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C38),

500 m distant

Visit: May 1994; 43 sherds

A site dispersed over a broad hilltop in the Umm Sawaneh ridge, between Wadis Zeith and edh-Dhba'ah, about 2 km south-east of Mekhora.

Over the hilltop descending to Wadi Zeith are spread five round and oval courtyards, each about 20 m in diameter. At the summit are two adjacent yards, built one above the other. The courtyards are not whole, and parts of

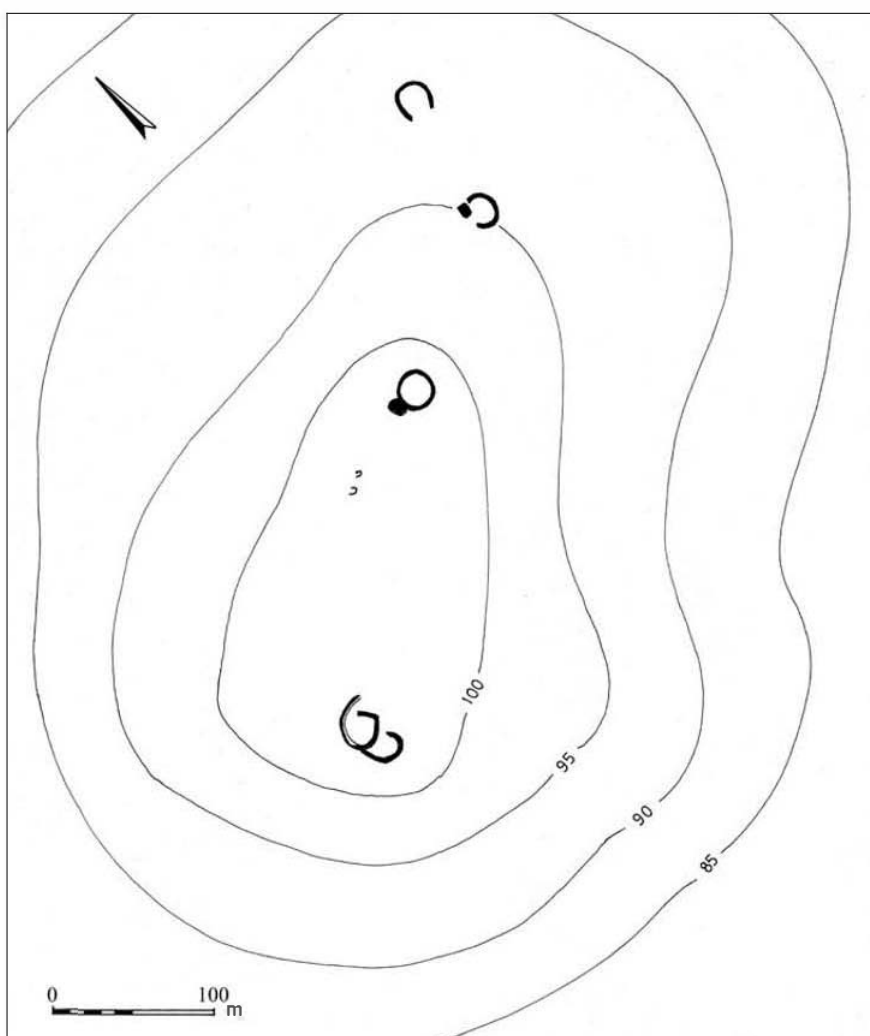
their circumferences were left open or broken through later, after the abandonment of the site.

There is another round courtyard and a small round structure attached to it, about 17● m to the north-east. 1●● m away down the spur is another open courtyard with a square structure inside it. The fifth courtyard, 5● m away, is the furthest down the spur to the north.

All the yards apparently served for livestock husbandry.

Pottery: Iron II – 21%; Late Roman – 65%; Middle Ages – 14%.

Additional surveys: none.



254. Plan of the courtyards at Umm Sawaneh (2), 1994.

Site 126: 19-17/12/2

UMM SAWANEH (3)

Israel grid: 1912/1722

UTM grid: 7297/5591

Elevation: 110 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: broad hilltop

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

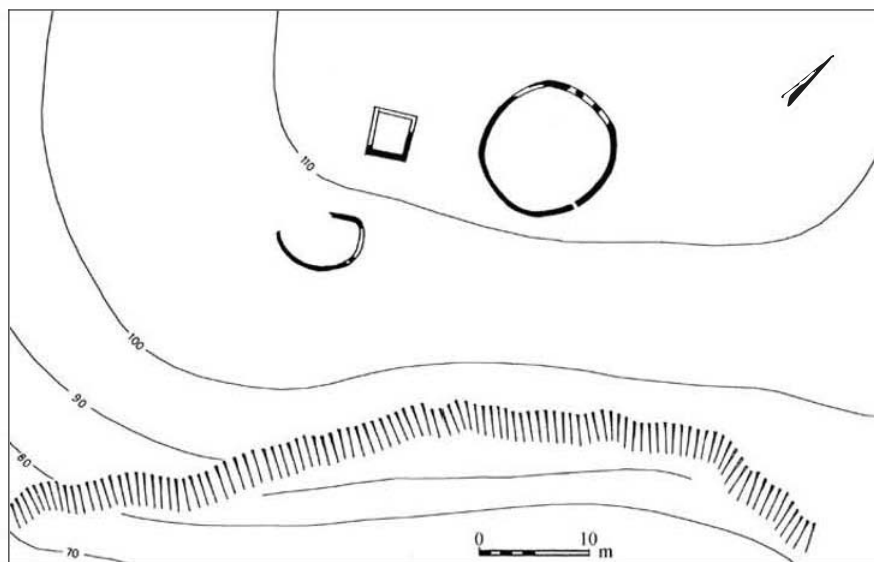
Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
2.2 km distantRoad: Jiftlik-Ṭana (C38),
next to the site

Visit: May 1994; 130 sherds

A site of enclosures on the south-western hilltop of the Umm Sawaneh ridge, by the cliffs descending south to the deep Wadi Zeith. An unpaved road from Mekhora passes close to the west of them and ascends to 'Iraq er-Resifeh and the Sartaba.

The main enclosure is round, 12 m in diameter, built of medium-sized stones. In its eastern side may be an opening. South-west of it is a square structure, only partially preserved, about 5×5 m. This structure, preserved one course high, is built of medium-sized stones. Close and south-west of it are the remains of another smaller partly preserved enclosure, 7 m in diameter.



255. Plan of Umm Sawaneh (3), 1994.

In and around the enclosures are considerable numbers of sherds and flint items. Judging by the number of sherds, the site was in extended use, mainly in the IA. The flint items are mainly dated to the Middle Palaeolithic.

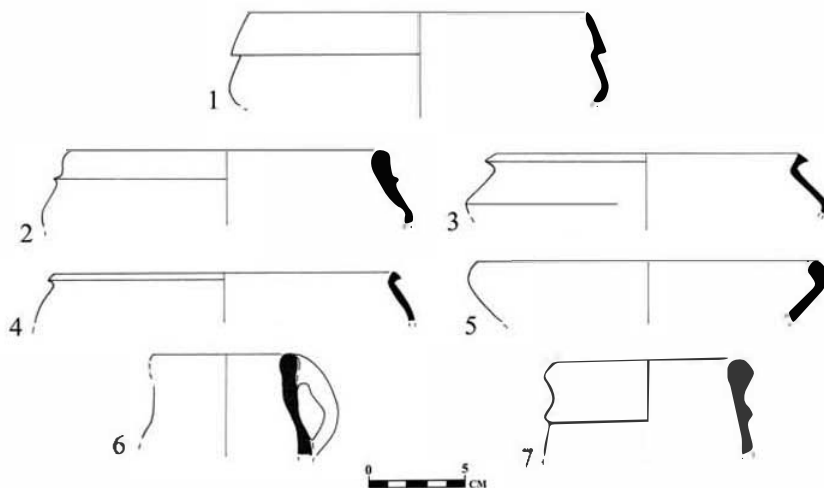
Pottery: Iron I – 48%; Iron II – 31%; Late Roman – 21%.

Flint: 162 items, Middle Palaeolithic, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



256. Umm Sawaneh (3), view to the south, 1994. In the background is the Sartaba range.



257. Pottery from Umm Sawaneh (3), all IA I and well fired: 1-4. CPs, dk brn; 5. 'Manasseh' bowl, buff; 6. Jug, buff; 7. Jar, lt brn.

Site 127: 19-17/12/3

WADI EZ-ZEITH (1)

Israel grid: 1910/1720

UTM grid: 7296/5588

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: structure and enclosure

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: spur

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown-forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops (partial)

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
2 km distantRoad: Jiftlik-Ṭana (C38),
next to the site

Visit: May 1994; 51 sherds

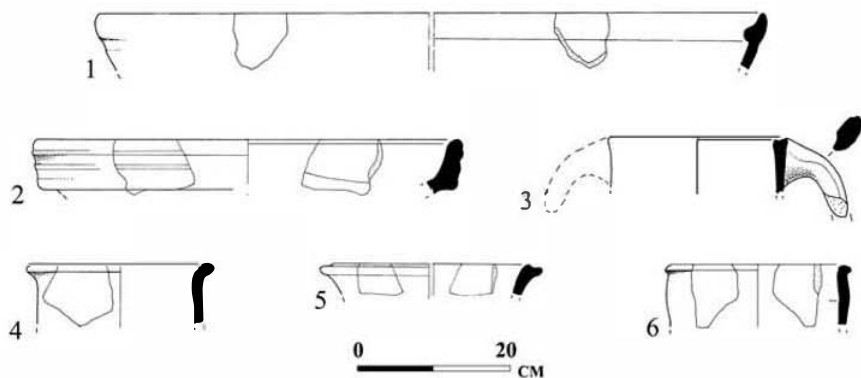
A site on a spur which ascends to the upper part of Wadi ez-Zeith, in the southern border of the inner valley of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah. Close by is an unpaved road from Mekhora which ascends to the er-Resifeh plateau.

In the site is a structure of large stones, measuring 5×5 m. About 60 m north of it is a round enclosure, about 15 m in diameter, encircled by a wall of medium-sized stones. West of the structure, over an area of 1 dunam (1000 sq. m), are the remains of a modern tent encampment.

Pottery: Late Roman – 9%; Byzantine – 43%; Ottoman – 24%; Modern – 24%.

Flint: 5 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



258. Pottery from Wadi ez-Zeith (1): 1. Krater, lt brn, Byz; 2. Bowl, rd, LR; 3. Jug, lt brn, LR; 4, 6. Jars, buff, LR; 5. Jug, pk, Byz.

Site 128: 19-17/32/2

‘IRAQ ER-RESIFEH (3)

Israel grid: 1933/1723

UTM grid: 7318/5591

Elevation: 110 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: structure and courtyard

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: plateau

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104),
2.2 km distantRoad: Jiftlik–Tana (C35),
500 m distant

Visit: March 1995; 47 sherds

A small site in the eastern part of the ‘Iraq er-Resifeh plateau, about 4 km south-east of Mekhora, from where is a fine view to the Wadi Far'ah valley.

There are two parts to the site:

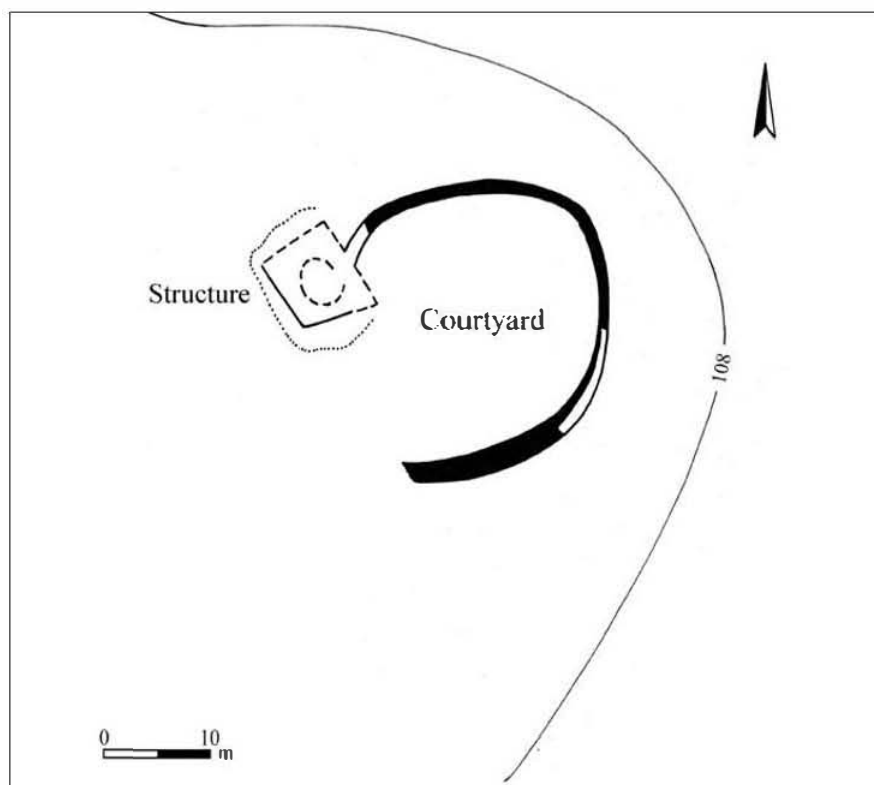
1. A square structure, measuring 6×6 m, built of small stones; its plan is not clear due to a considerable cover of stones. In the east is attached an irregular enclosure, about 25 m in diameter, of varying thickness (0.8–2 m), built of small stones. In and around the enclosure are concentrations of LR sherds.
2. Over an area of about 4 dunams (4000 sq. m) around the structure and the courtyard is a sparse Chalcolithic period sherd scatter. It seems that there is no linkage between these parts of the site.

Apparently, there was an encampment site without structures during the Chalcolithic period, perhaps connected to the large Chalcolithic sites in Wadi Far'ah. In the IA II a dwelling site (farm?) was established, and a Roman site on top of that.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 21%; Iron II – 15%; Late Roman – 53%; Byzantine – 11%.

Additional surveys: none.

Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 61.



259. Plan of 'Iraq er-Resifeh (3), 1995.



260. General view of 'Iraq er-Resifeh (3), view to the west, 1995. The human figures are standing on the remains of the central structure.

Site 128 (1): 19-17/32/4

‘IRAQ ER-RESIFEH PLATEAU

Israel grid: 1933/1722 (centre)	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 7318/5591	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 105 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: Wadi Far’ah (104), 2 km distant
Site type: prehistoric	Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35), 500 m distant
Area: 150 dunams (15 ha)	Visit: March 2013
Topography: plateau	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

A very large prehistoric site in the ‘Iraq er-Resifeh plateau, about 4 km south-east of Mekhora, from where there is a fine view to the Wadi Far’ah valley.

Many flint items are scattered over an estimated area of 150 dunams (15 ha) of the plateau. Most of the datable finds are from the Middle Palaeolithic period. It is noteworthy that not all the area is covered with flints, and there are gaps between large concentrations. It is therefore reasonable to suggest that we are dealing with several sites from this period (and possibly other, later, Prehistoric periods as well).

Four find spots were chosen for a detailed analysis in different locations around the site (see Appendix A), and the site was dated to the Middle Palaeolithic period.

Flint: 1091 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Site 129: 19-17/32/3

‘IRAQ ER-RESIFEH (2)

Israel grid: 1931/1721	Soil type: stony-desert
UTM grid: 7316/5390	Soil quality: 6
Elevation: 105 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: none
Name: nearest place	Cisterns: none
Site type: structures, courtyard and enclosure	Water source: Wadi Far'ah (104), 2.3 km distant
Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)	Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35), 300 m distant
Topography: spur and summit	Visit: March 1995; 155 sherds
Rock type: Avdat Group	

A site on a flat hilltop and spur in the western margins of the ‘Iraq er-Resifeh plateau, south of the high hilltop of E.P. 163. The location is 4 km east of Mekhora, and is a part of a complex of sites on the ‘Iraq er-Resifeh plateau.

The site spreads over a moderate spur, sloping west to the deep Wadi Zeith. In the upper part, on a low hilltop, is a courtyard about 20×20 m, with a wall about 1 m thick. In its southern part is a small round structure of large stones, about 4 m in diameter. Next to it is a rock-cut cupmark. The square courtyard is inside a round large interrupted enclosure wall, the original diameter of which was about 50 m. The wall is about 1.5 m thick, and there is an opening in its western side. It is quite likely that originally the wall encircled the entire summit. Inside the enclosure is a cave with a collapsed ceiling.

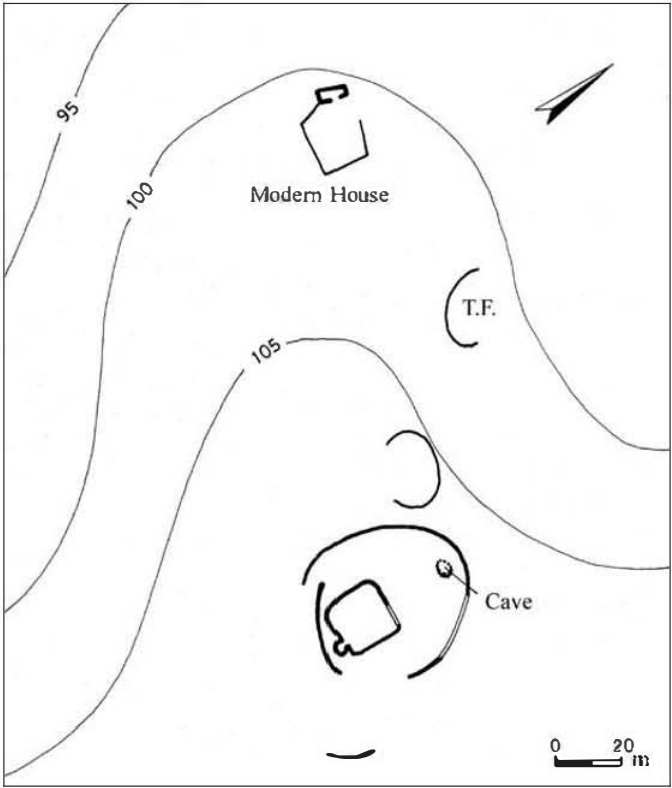
North-west of these structures are remains of another enclosure about 15 m in diameter, built of medium-sized stones, and open on the west side. About 30 m west, down the spur, is a built threshing floor.

About 70 m north-north-west of the site centre, down the spur, is a recent structure (Ottoman or modern) of small stones, measuring 5×3 m, with a courtyard attached to its south-eastern side. This complex was built of stones taken from the ancient structures.

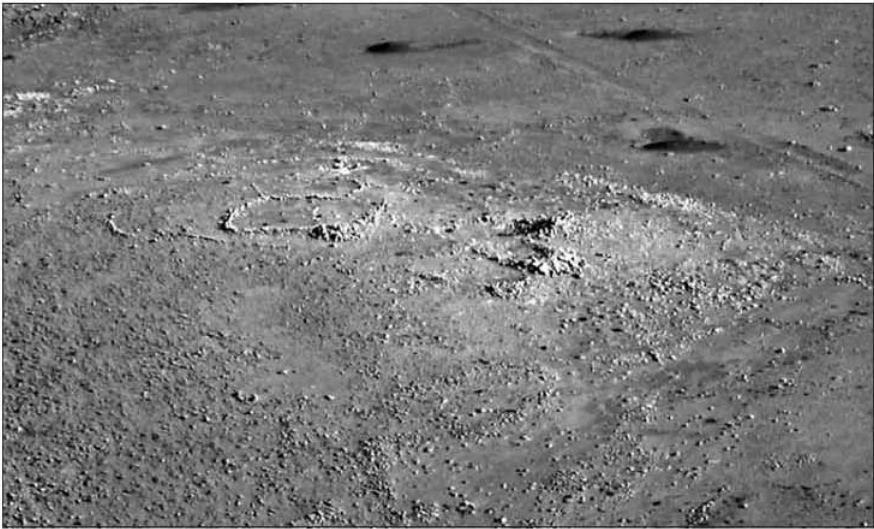
This large site includes enclosures and flock-pens, and was apparently the central site in the ‘Iraq er-Resifeh plateau. Judging by the number of sherds the place was a dwelling site. It was founded in the IA II (8th century BCE), and was in use at least until the end of the Byzantine period.

Pottery: Iron II – 18%; Hellenistic – 4%; Early Roman – 12%; Late Roman – 52%; Byzantine – 4%; Middle Ages – 2%; Modern – 8%.

Additional surveys: none.



261. Plan of 'Iraq er-Resifeh (2), 1995.



262. Aerial view of 'Iraq er-Resifeh (2), view to the north, 2013 (A. Solomon).

Site 130: 18-17/91/1

JEBEL EL-MAHJARAH (2)

Israel grid: 1898/1716	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7283/5584	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 378 m a.s.l., 150 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177), 2 km distant
Site type: enclosure	Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35/38), 500 m distant
Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha)	Visit: June 1994; 78 sherds
Topography: high summit	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: desert lithosol	

A large enclosure with structures at its centre on the high summit of Jebel el-Mahjarah (E.P. 378), about 3 km south of Mekhora. The summit is the north-western edge of the Sartaba range, and overlooks the mountainous zone between the villages of Mekhora and Gittit.

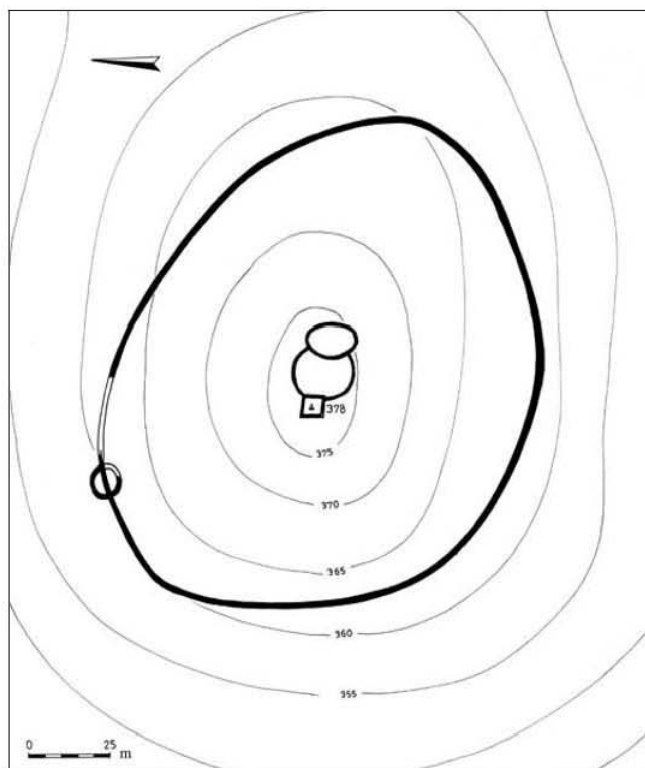
The summit is at the centre of an enclosure, most of whose components are well preserved. The enclosure wall is built of medium-sized stones, and is about 1.5 m thick. The enclosure is oval, measuring about 150 m from east to west and 120 m from north to south. Integrated into its north-western wall, half inside the enclosure and half outside, is a round structure 5 m in diameter. Inside the structure are two large monoliths. It is very probable that this was the entrance structure into a temenos.

At the enclosure centre (the summit) is a three-element complex:

1. To the west is a square structure, built of medium-sized stones, measuring 7×7 m.
2. East of the structure and abutting it is an oval courtyard about 10 m across.
3. Another smaller yard abuts courtyard no. 2, extending eastward.

In the eastern part of the enclosure is a rock-cut installation.

This large site has several unusual features: firstly, its location on the summit of a high mountain dominating the entire region; secondly, the wall of the large enclosure is unusual and was not meant for defence and also not as an animal pen; thirdly, the pottery assemblage is not typical of the region; and fourthly, this is the only site in the Sartaba range founded in the MBA, although 4 km to the west and south-west are clusters of MBA sites. Therefore we are inclined to view the site as a place of worship, requiring additional research.



263. Plan of Jebel el-Mahjarah (2), 1994.

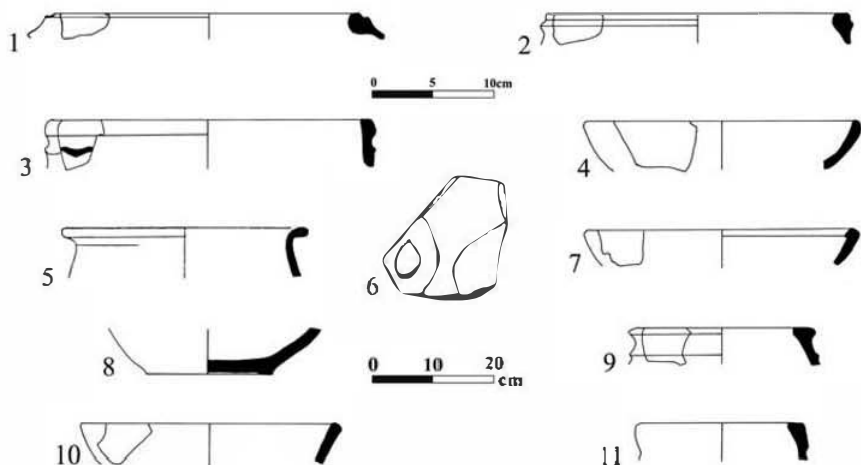


264. Aerial view of Jebel el-Mahjarah (2), to the south-east, 1997. The black line indicates the line of the enclosure wall (M. Einav).

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 8%; Late Bronze (?) – 18%; Iron I – 4%; Iron II – 65%; Late Roman – 5%. In the site were found 10 rims of open and rounded bowls; these belong shape-wise to the LBA period, but ware-wise to the IA I; it is difficult to ascertain to what period they actually belong.

Flint: 11 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



265. Pottery from Jebel el-Mahjarah (2): 1-2. CPs, dk brn, Ir II; 3. Krater, brn, LB/Ir I; 4. 'Manasseh' bowl, buff, Ir I; 5. Jar, dk brn, LB/Ir I; 6. Ledge handle?, buff; 7, 10. Bowls, buff-cream, MB II; 8. Bowl base, buff, MB II, 9. Jar, buff, Ir II; 11. Jar, brn, LR.



266. Jebel el-Mahjarah (2), S. Hashman standing in the central yard on the temenos summit, 1994.

Site 131: 19-17/01/2

WADI EDH-DHBA'AH (3)

Israel grid: 1905/1716	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 7290/5584	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 218 m a.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
Site type: farm	1.5 km distant
Area: 9 dunams (9000 sq. m)	Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35),
Topography: high saddle	next to the site
Rock type: Avdat Group	Visit: June 1994; 67 sherds
Soil type: desert lithosol	

A farm, structures and threshing floors on a wide saddle, nearby and south of E.P. 218, about 3 km south of Mekhora. The saddle is a part of high spur which dominates the Mekhora Valley, the Umm Sawaneh spur, Wadi Zeith and the valley of Wadi Far'ah.

The site has three parts: a central structure, the road, and the threshing floors:

1. The central structure is in the southern part of the saddle. It is an elongated structure, the original measurements of which were 12×5 m. Only 10 m of the long wall remains: the rest has been destroyed. It looks as if the structure was divided into rooms. The walls are preserved 1 m high, and the construction is of large stones.

An oval courtyard about 7 m across is attached to the north-eastern side of the structure: its wall is about 1.5 m thick. To the southern edge of the courtyard wall is attached a circle of large stones about 5 m in diameter, and next to it is a small structure – perhaps a silo.

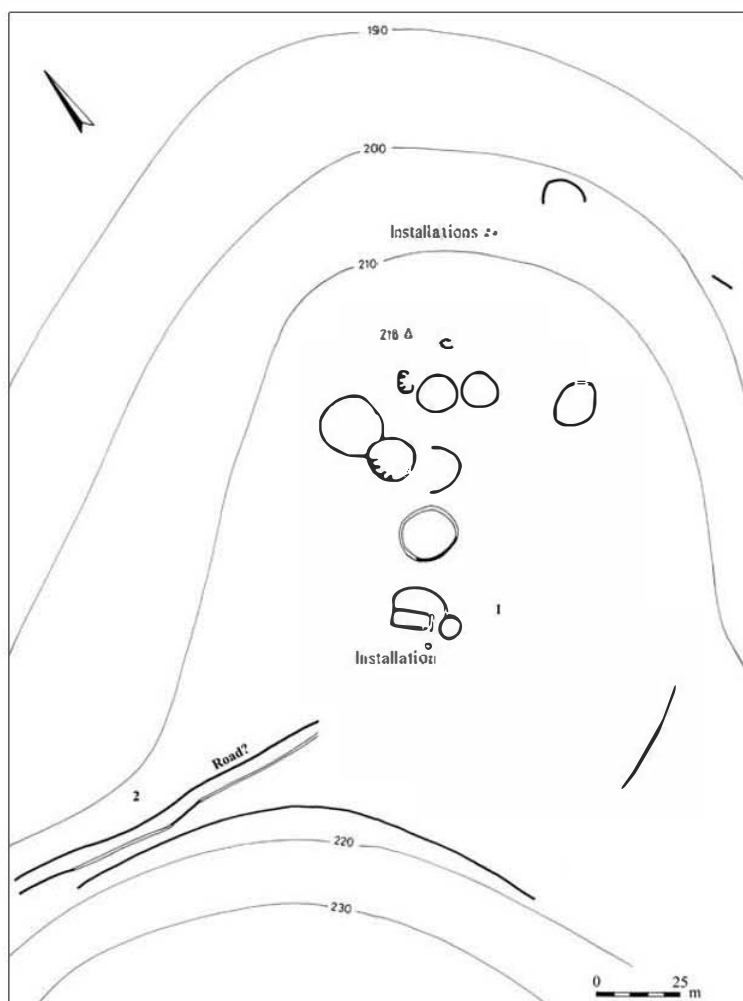
2. The built road (C35) reaches the structure and continues east and west. Like other Roman roads, it is built of two parallel walls 5 m apart and paved sections.
3. At least seven round or oval threshing floors were found scattered over the spur up to a distance of 120 m north-east of the central structure. Five of them are about 10 m in diameter, encircled by a bordering wall 30 to 80 cm thick built of small- and medium-sized stones. The soil was removed from the threshing floors and they were found to contain levelling fillings and cleared rock surfaces, and occasionally rock-cut installations. The two other threshing floors, which are built in an identical manner, are larger – 15 to 20 m in diameter.

Five built installations were also found, perhaps silos. They are 2 m in diameter, with walls of medium-sized stones standing to a height of 1 m, with an opening. Four of the installations were found inside the threshing floors.

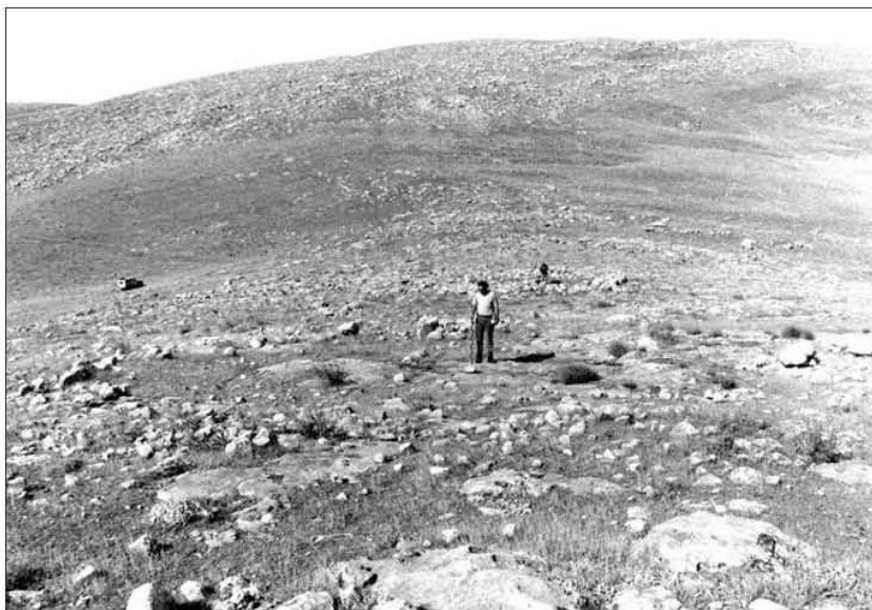
The site is a well-developed farm growing cereals. The threshing floor assemblage indicates that the place served as hub for the population of the vicinity. It may have served as a structure guarding the road.

Pottery: Iron II – 48%; Early Roman – 2%; Late Roman – 33%; Byzantine – 12%; unidentified – 5%.

Additional surveys: none.



267. Plan of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (3), 1994.



268. General view to the north of Wadi edh-Dhba'ah (3), 1994.



Site 132: 19-17/11/1

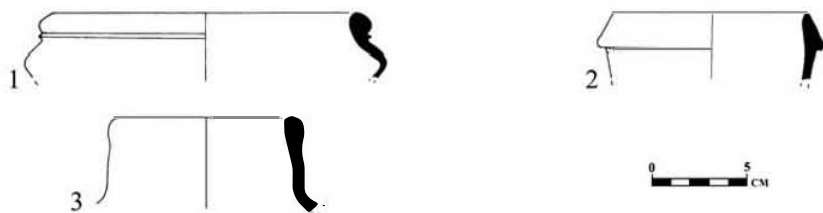
WADI EZ-ZEITH (2)

Israel grid: 1912/1719
 UTM grid: 7297/5587
 Elevation: 115 m a.s.l., 3● m a.s.a.
 Name: nearest place
 Site type: farm
 Area: 2 dunams (2●●● sq. m)
 Topography: spur
 Rock type: Avdat Group
 Soil type: brown-forest

Soil quality: 5
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
 2 km distant
 Road: Jiftlik-Tana (C38),
 next to the site
 Visit: May 1994; 5● sherds

A site on a low spur, descending north from the el-Mureighat ridges to Wadi ez-Zeith; located east of and close to the site of Wadi ez-Zeith (1) – No. 127, from which is a view to the upper course of the deep Wadi ez-Zeith.

The site contains a rectangular structure measuring 5×4 m, built of large stones, disturbed by recent activities. South of it is a circle surrounded by a stone wall, about 15 m in diameter, probably a threshing floor. A similar thresh-



26g. Pottery from Wadi ez-Zeith (2): 1. CP, dk brn, Ir II; 2. Jug, brn, LR; 3. Jar, lt brn, LR.

ing floor, about 10 m in diameter, lies 7–8 m east of the structure, and another one 30 m to the east. About 40 m east of the site, along the spur, are the remains of a modern Bedouin encampment.

This is an IA and Roman period farm or small settlement. The concentration of threshing floors is typical of the region.

Pottery: Iron II – 40%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 20%; Middle Ages – 4%; Ottoman – 16%.

Flint: 13 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 133: 19-17/11/2

EL-MUREIGHAT (E.P. 280)

Israel grid: 1918/1718

UTM grid: 7303/5586

Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: structure and yard (fort?)

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: desert lithosol

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

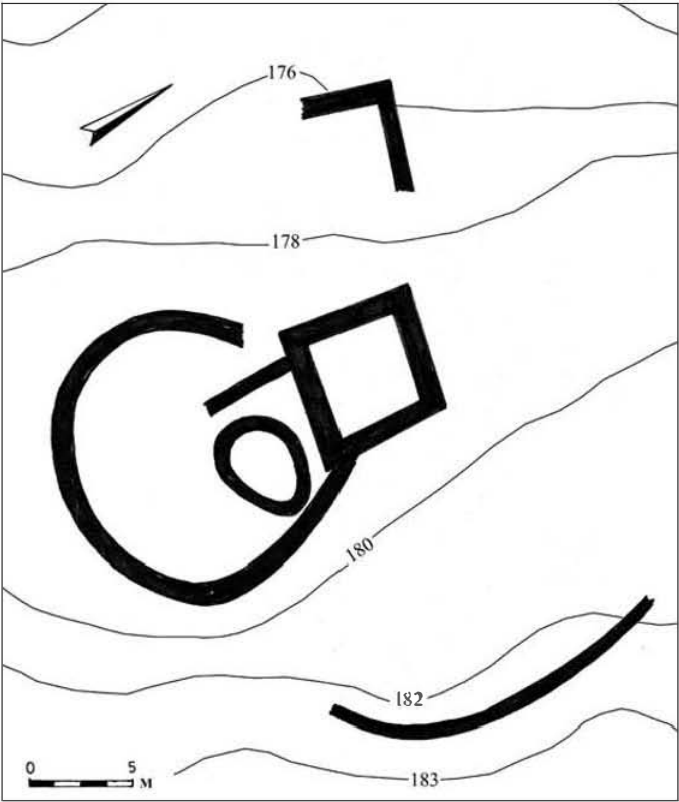
Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
1.8 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35),
next to the site

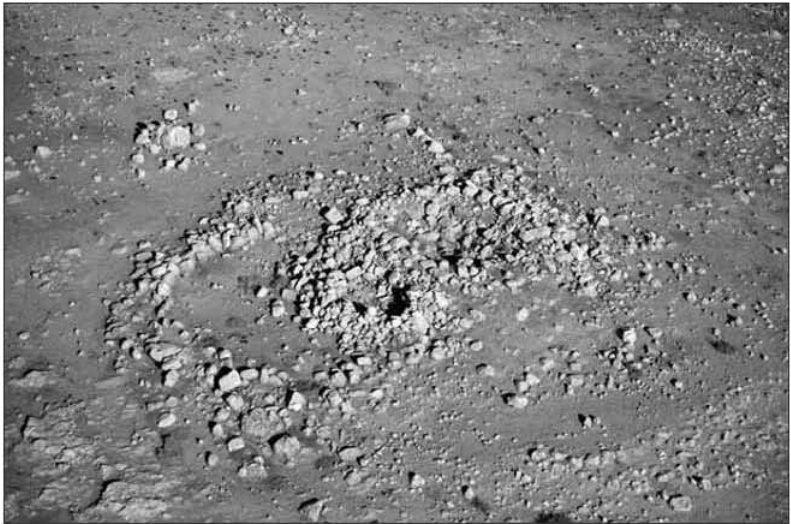
Visit: June 1994; 61 sherds

A site in a saddle on the northern slope of E.P. 280, about 3 km south-east of Mekhora. From the site is a view to the hill area between the Sartaba and Wadi Far'ah.

There is a square structure in the site measuring about 7×7 m, built from large stones: its walls are about 2 m thick. A courtyard built of large stones is



270. Plan of el-Mureighat, 1994.



271. Aerial view of el-Mureighat, 2013 (A. Solomon).

attached to its southern side. Inside the yard is a stone circle, perhaps a more recent shepherds' resting place (*maq'ad*). To the west of the complex are the remains of an earlier enclosure, built of medium-sized stones.

The place is mentioned by Ilan and Damati (1975: 46) as a fort (at incorrect coordinates) without other remarks.

Apparently, the site served as a fort or guard post, positioned next to the Jiftlik–Tana–Neapolis Roman road. Beside the Roman road passes a new unpaved road which ascends to 'Iraq er-Resifeh. Along the Roman road are two other similar sites. The existence of the site in the IA might indicate the use of the road at that period.

Pottery: Iron II – 15%; Hellenistic – 2%; Late Roman – 61%; Byzantine – 13%; Ottoman – 9%.

Additional surveys: none.

Bibliography: Ilan 1973: 293.



Site 134: 19-17/21/1

'IRAQ ER-RESIFEH (4)

Israel grid: 1928/1717

UTM grid: 7314/5586

Elevation: 110 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: enclosures

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: plateau

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Abu Daraj (177),
2.7 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Tana (C35), next to the
site

Visit: March 1995; 19 sherds

A small site on a low hilltop in the 'Iraq er-Resifeh plateau, about 500 m south-east of E.P. 152, and 4 km south-east of Mekhora.

In the centre of the site is a round enclosure, about 15 m in diameter, surrounded by a wall one stone thick. There was possibly another smaller enclosure, north of this one.

Over the hilltop area next to the structures are stone heaps of of varied shapes and types. Some appear to be tumuli, and the others are perhaps heaps of cleared stones.

About 50 m south of the site passes the Roman road C35; however, its relation to the site is uncertain.

There is a combination of several uncommon features in the place: enclosures without structures, tumuli, heaps of stones and a small sherd scatter.

Pottery: Iron I – 4%; Iron II – 41%; Early Roman – 14%; Late Roman – 36%; Byzantine – 5%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 135: 19-17/21/3

‘IRAQ ER-RESIFEH (1)

Israel grid: 1928/1714

UTM grid: 7313/5583

Elevation: 115 m a.s.l., 0 m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: plateau

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: ‘Ein Abu Daraj (177),
2.3 km distant

Road: Jiftlik–Ṭana (C35),
next to the site

Visit: March 1995; 66 sherds

A structure and courtyard in the south-western part of ‘Iraq er-Resifeh plateau, 4 km south-east of Mekhora.

In the site is a structure measuring 9×6 m built of large stones with walls 1 m thick. Judging by the pile of large stones by the structure, it could be assumed that it originally stood up about 2 m high. The opening was not preserved.

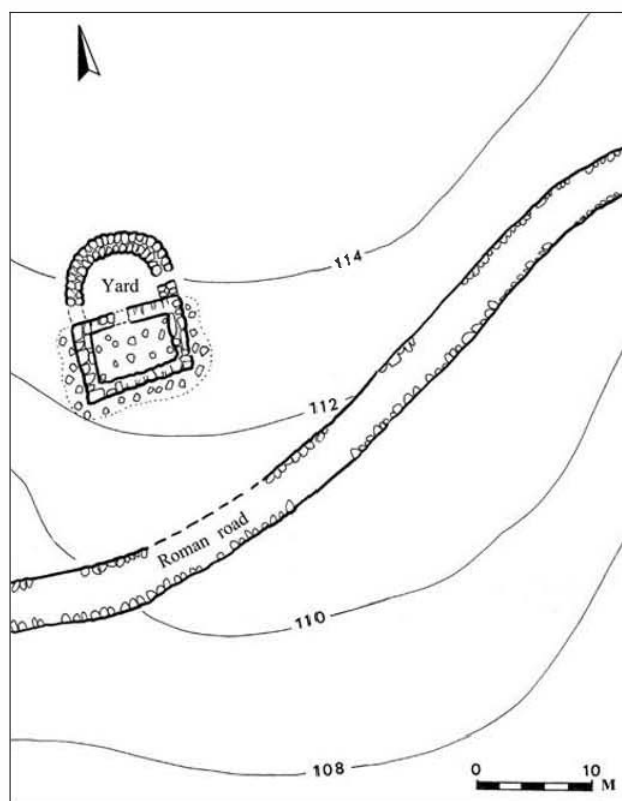
Attached to the structure to the north is an oval courtyard, about 7 m across. Its encircling wall is 130 cm thick, built of two rows of carefully laid large stones. Apparently, the entrance to the yard was in the western corner, between the structure and the courtyard wall.

The Jiftlik–Ṭana–Neapolis Roman road (C35) passes the site. Beyond the road, about 50 m north-east of the structure, is a small structure built of large stones, the centre of which has been dug and robbed.

The site probably served as a fort guarding the road.

Pottery: Late Roman – 100%.

Additional surveys: none.



272. Plan of 'Iraq er-Resifeh (1), 1995.



273. Aerial view to the north of 'Iraq er-Resifeh (1), 2013 (A Solomon).